

COMPETENCY PORTFOLIO

CHRIS COX

Updated 2026



2026 Update and Contents

This edition keeps every page from the existing portfolio and adds a current evidence supplement. The supplement uses the same cover-sheet-and-artifact approach as the original binder. Shared projects are described as shared work, and private operational files are not reproduced.

Section	Pages
Existing competency portfolio (preserved in full)	3–164
2025 Annual Report — selected program results	165–167
Master Event Tasklist — responsibility excerpts	168–171
2026 Military Family Ball — planning excerpts	172–175
2026 State Teen Panel Retreat — agenda excerpts	176–178
2026 Military Youth Summer Camp — program plan excerpts	179–181
Social Media Tracker — representative outreach excerpts	182–184

Privacy note. Current spend-plan and end-of-month reporting files were reviewed but are not reproduced because the working files include personal contact, travel, or family information. Their exclusion does not remove any page from the existing binder.

COMPETENCY PORTFOLIO

C H R I S
C O X

Updated 2024

Table of Contents

1. Competency 1	Page 3
Artifact: STP Retreat Agenda	
2. Competency 2	Page 6
Artifact: Self Discovery Training	
3. Competency 3	Page 40
Artifact: MOMC Classroom Kits	
4. Competency 4	Page 46
Artifact: Partnership Portfolio	
5. Competency 5	Page 48
Artifact: Volunteer Process Email Templates	
6. Competency 6	Page 57
Artifact: Marketing Plan	
7. Competency 7	Page 61
Artifact: Regional Expansion Timeline	
8. Competency 8	Page 64
Artifact: Yellow Ribbon Curriculum	
9. Competency 9	Page 114
Artifact: Reenlistment Resource Guide	
10. Competency 10	Page 118
Artifact: MOMC Events, FY24 Spend Plan, Quarterly STP Agendas	
11. Competency 11	Page 137
Artifact: MCEC Professional Development	

Professional Portfolio Introduction & Competency Areas

Welcome to this professional portfolio, showcasing a comprehensive record of achievements within the Iowa Army National Guard's Child and Youth Services (CYS). This portfolio illustrates the application of key competencies in real-world scenarios, emphasizing the positive impact on military-connected youth and families, and soldier readiness and retention.

Competency Areas:

- 1. Program Planning, Implementation, and Management:** Mastery in developing and executing programs that support military families.
- 2. Youth Growth, Development, and Resiliency:** Deep understanding of the factors affecting the well-being of military children.
- 3. Community and Education Outreach:** Engaging with communities to provide educational and supportive resources.
- 4. Positive and Collaborative Partnerships:** Building and maintaining partnerships that enhance program reach and effectiveness.
- 5. Volunteer Recruitment and Retention:** Skills in attracting and keeping dedicated volunteer teams.
- 6. Effective Marketing Plans:** Designing marketing strategies that effectively communicate program benefits.
- 7. Growth of CYS through Local Initiatives:** Commitment to expanding CYS's impact through targeted local projects.
- 8. Working within the ARNG Community:** Understanding the unique aspects of the ARNG environment and its members.
- 9. Soldier Readiness and Retention:** Initiatives aimed at supporting soldiers' readiness and encouraging their continued service.
- 10. Deliverable Submission:** Completing and submitting all required program deliverables efficiently.
- 11. Professional Growth and Development:** Ongoing efforts to enhance professional skills and knowledge relevant to supporting military families.

This introduction and the detailed competency areas aim to provide a clear understanding of the portfolio's purpose and the essential roles played within the CYS framework, demonstrating a profound commitment to the military community.



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child and Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Agenda from State Teen Panel Retreat

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...I am including this document in my professional portfolio because it demonstrates the following:

- 1. Knowledge:** The execution of this event necessitated meticulous logistical planning to establish a schedule encompassing all objectives and prerequisites for the STP event. Proficiency in understanding specific objectives, goals, and requirements was essential for implementing effective programming.
- 2. Implementation:** The agenda for the STP Retreat comprehensively outlined each event and programming element deployed to fulfill the stated objectives and goals, encompassing various aims such as enhancing communication skills, promoting physical fitness and well-being, fostering teamwork and collaboration, encouraging community engagement and service, developing technical or artistic skills, promoting personal growth and resilience, refining planning and organizational abilities, and nurturing creativity and innovation. Examples of implementing these objectives included team-building activities, educational and skills-focused lessons, community service opportunities, physical and resilience-building exercises at NinjaU, and providing support and encouragement for the team.
- 3. Management:** During the preparatory phase, adept management of task delegation, coupled with effective communication with venues and organizations, proved pivotal for the successful planning of the STP Retreat.

TRAVEL

Transportation Notice for STP Retreat

Individual transportation arrangements are required for the members to attend the STP Retreat. We will not be providing transport for youth participants. For the convenience and safety of our STP members, we have arranged for a background-checked service member to oversee all group transportation needs during the retreat.

Objective Key:

- **A:** Enhance Communication Skills
- **B:** Promote Physical Fitness and Well-being
- **C:** Foster Teamwork and Collaboration
- **D:** Encourage Community Engagement and Service
- **E:** Develop Technical or Artistic Skills
- **F:** Encourage Personal Growth and Resilience
- **G:** Planning and Organizational Skills
- **H:** Cultivate Creativity and Innovation

STP Retreat Agenda Objectives

Friday PM

- **12:30** - Pick up rental vehicle
- **3:00** - Arrive at hotel and prepare conference room for STP
 - **Objective G:** Set up a conducive environment for learning and interaction.
- **5:00** - STP Arrive at Hotel and Unpack
- **5:30** - Dinner (Conversation about MOMC)
 - **Objective A & C:** Discuss and exchange ideas on Month of the Military Child involvement and encouragement strategies while collaborating ideas.
- **6:30** - Team Building (Ice breakers, Rope Exercises, Games, etc.)
 - **Objective C & H:** Engage in activities that promote unity and creativity among participants.
- **9:00** - Lights out

Saturday AM

- **8:00** - Breakfast (Talk about book *Do Hard Things*)
 - **Objective F:** Motivate STP to undertake personal challenges and encourage STP members to read and reflect through the book.
- **9:00** - Educational/Skill Lesson (Photography)

- **Objective E & H:** Learn a new artistic skill, fostering creativity and stepping out of comfort zones.

- **11:30** - Lunch (Subway)

Saturday PM

- **1:00** - Community Service Opportunity (Northeast Iowa Food Bank)
 - **Objective D:** Provide service to the local community, reinforcing the importance of civic engagement.
- **3:00** - Resilience Building & Training w/ Exercise (Ninja U)
 - **Objective B & F:** Develop physical fitness while encouraging resilience through challenging activities.
- **5:30** - Dinner (Pizza Ranch)
- **6:30** - Return to hotel
- **7:00** - Team Building (teamwork games)
 - **Objective C:** Strengthen team dynamics through engaging and cooperative games.

Sunday AM

- **8:00** - Breakfast (at hotel)
- **8:30** - Summer Schedule and Plan
 - **Objective G:** Collaboratively create a summer schedule that facilitates growth and involvement.
- **9:00** - STP Support/Team Building/Encouragement
 - **Objective A & F:** Write notes of encouragement to reinforce the community bond and acknowledge individual efforts.
- **9:45** - After Action Review (AAR)
 - **Objective G:** Reflect on the retreat's events, discuss what went well, and identify areas for improvement.
- **10:00** - Clean Up and STP Travel
 - **Objective G:** Demonstrate responsibility and care for the environment by leaving it in good condition.
- **10:30** - Travel back to Des Moines
- **1:00** - Return Rental at Enterprise in Johnston



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

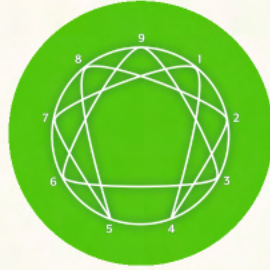
LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	2, 11
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Youth Self-Discovery Training

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...it showcases my innovative approach to enhancing youth growth, development, and resiliency through the application of the Enneagram personality system. This presentation reflects my deep understanding of the complexities of youth development and my ability to leverage psychological frameworks to foster self-awareness, empathy, and interpersonal skills among young individuals. It demonstrates my commitment to providing youth, particularly those within the Army National Guard community, with the tools and knowledge they need to navigate their personal and social worlds more effectively. By introducing them to the Enneagram, I aimed to empower them with insights into their personality traits, motivations, and behaviors, thereby encouraging personal growth and resilience. This artifact exemplifies my dedication to using creative and engaging methods to support the holistic development of youth, showcasing my expertise in the field and my innovative strategies for promoting emotional intelligence and resilience.



DISCOVERING YOU

An Adventure into
the Enneagram

2 Enneagram Types Overview

8 Different Types

Type 1: The Perfectionist



1 Understanding the Enneagram

What is it?



3 Discover Your Enneagram



4 Dive Deeper into Your Enneagram Type

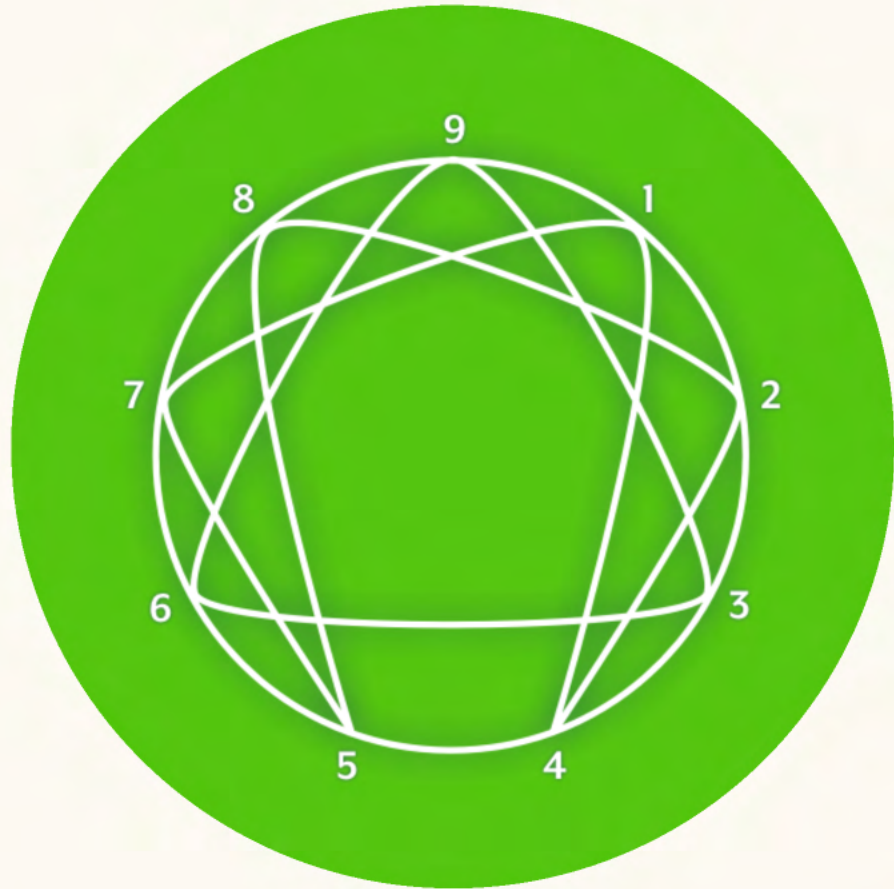


5 Conclusion

Applying the Enneagram in Everyday Life

Bring it Home





DISCOVERING YOU

An Adventure into
the Enneagram

1

Understanding the Enneagram

What is it?

Definition: The Enneagram is an ancient personality typing system that describes nine distinct personality types and their interconnections.

Each type represents a worldview and archetype that resonates with the way people think, feel, and act in relation to the world, others, and themselves.

2

Enneagram Types

Overview

9 Different Types

Each type has its own way of seeing the world and an underlying motivation that drives its behavior.

The types are interconnected, showing the complexity of human nature and potential for growth.

Note: The numerical value doesn't mean that one is better than the other.

9 Enneagram Types

"Discovering another person's Enneagram type can be just as insightful and life-changing as discovering your own."

Type 1: The Reformer
Type 2: The Helper
Type 3: The Achiever
Type 4: The Individualist
Type 5: The Investigator
Type 6: The Loyalist
Type 7: The Enthusiast
Type 8: The Challenger
Type 9: The Peacemaker

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Type 1: The Reformer

Description: Principled, self-controlled, and perfectionistic.

Core Motivation: Desire to be good, ethical, and right.

Key Attributes: Strong sense of right and wrong, commitment to improvement, critical of self and others, integrity, and discipline.



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Type 2: The Helper

Description: Caring, interpersonal, and generous.

Core Motivation: Need to be loved and needed.

Key Attributes: Empathetic, sincere, people-pleasing, prone to flattery, and a tendency to neglect their own needs.



9 Enneagram Types

"Discovering another person's Enneagram type can be just as insightful and life-changing as discovering your own."

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Type 9: The Peacemaker

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Type 3: The Achiever

Description: Success-oriented, adaptive, and excelling.

Core Motivation: Desire to feel valuable and accepted.

Key Attributes: Ambitious, driven, image-conscious, highly focused on goals, and adaptable.



9 Enneagram Types

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Type 4: The Individualist

Description: Sensitive, introspective, and expressive.

Core Motivation: Desire to find themselves and their significance.

Key Attributes: Creative, unique, authentic, emotionally honest, and sometimes moody.



9 Enneagram Types

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Type 9: The Peacemaker

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Type 5: The Investigator

Description: Intense, cerebral, and perceptive.

Core Motivation: Need to gain knowledge and understand the environment.

Key Attributes: Insightful, curious, innovative, detached from emotions, and private.



9 Enneagram Types

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Type 6: The Loyalist

Description: Committed, security-oriented, and engaging.

Core Motivation: Need for security and support.

Key Attributes: Responsible, trustworthy, anxious, loyal to ideas or people, and questioning.



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Type 7: The Enthusiast

Description: Busy, fun-loving, and spontaneous.

Core Motivation: Desire to maintain freedom and happiness.

Key Attributes: Versatile, optimistic, acquisitive, prone to distraction, and scattered.



9 Enneagram Types

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Type 9: The Peacemaker

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Type 8: The Challenger

Description: Powerful, dominating, and self-confident.

Core Motivation: Need to protect themselves and be in control.

Key Attributes: Decisive, willful, confrontational, protective of the weak, and challenging of authority.



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Type 9: The Peacemaker

Description: Easygoing, self-effacing, and receptive.

Core Motivation: Desire for inner stability and peace of mind.

Key Attributes: Peaceful, unassuming, agreeable, complacent, and sometimes neglectful of their own priorities.



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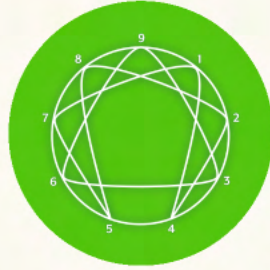
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DISCOVERING YOU

An Adventure into
the Enneagram

2 Enneagram Types Overview

8 Different Types

Type 1: The Perfectionist



1 Understanding the Enneagram

What is it?



Enneagram Type

3 Discover Your Enneagram

Enneagram Quiz



4 Dive Deeper into Your Enneagram Type

Enneagram Type



5 Conclusion

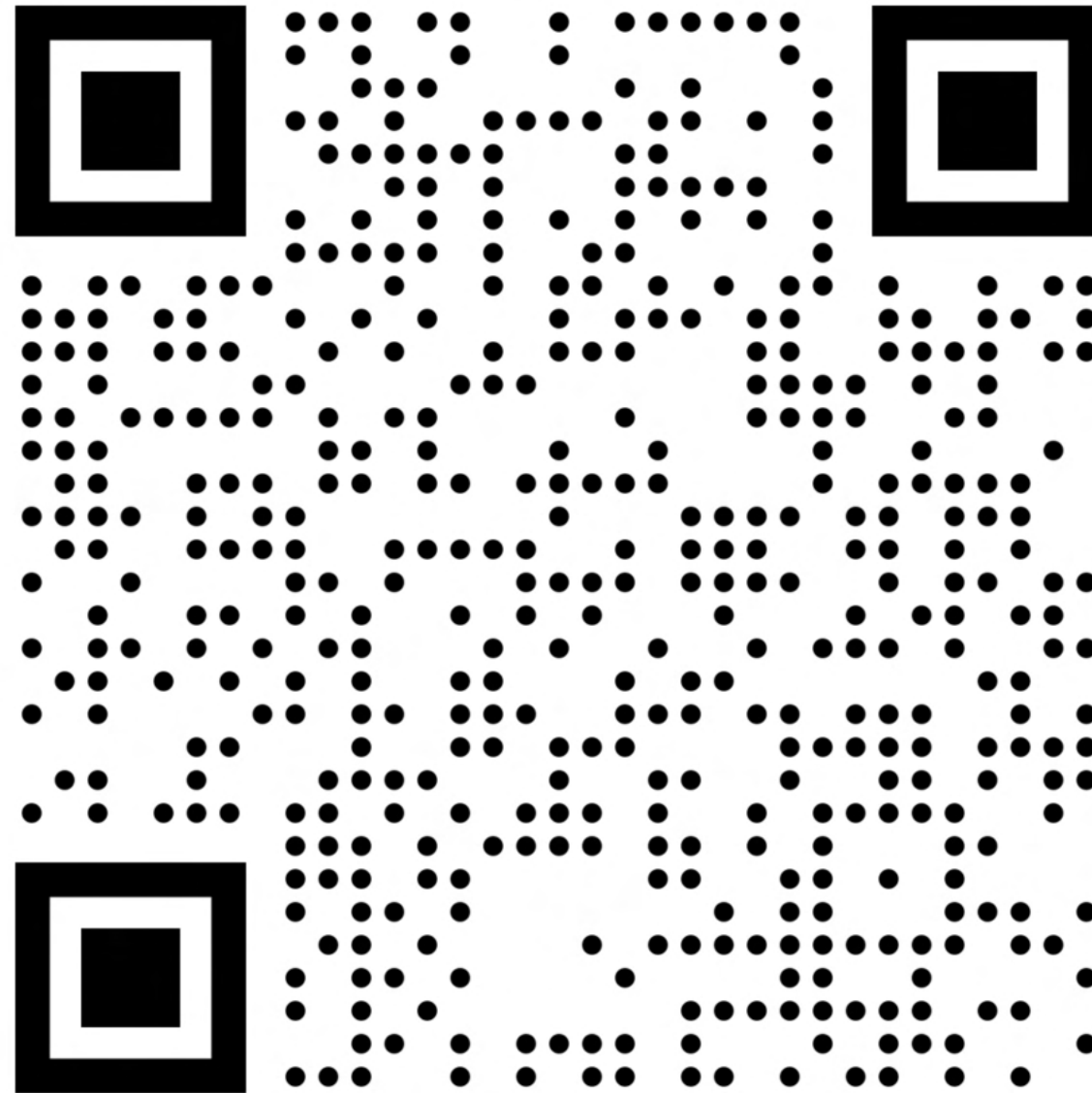
Applying the Enneagram in Everyday Life

Bring it
Home

3

Discover Your Enneagram

Enneagram Quiz



Scan the
QR Code
and
answer
the
questions
without
over
analyzing.
Skip pg 7

Time: 15 min

4

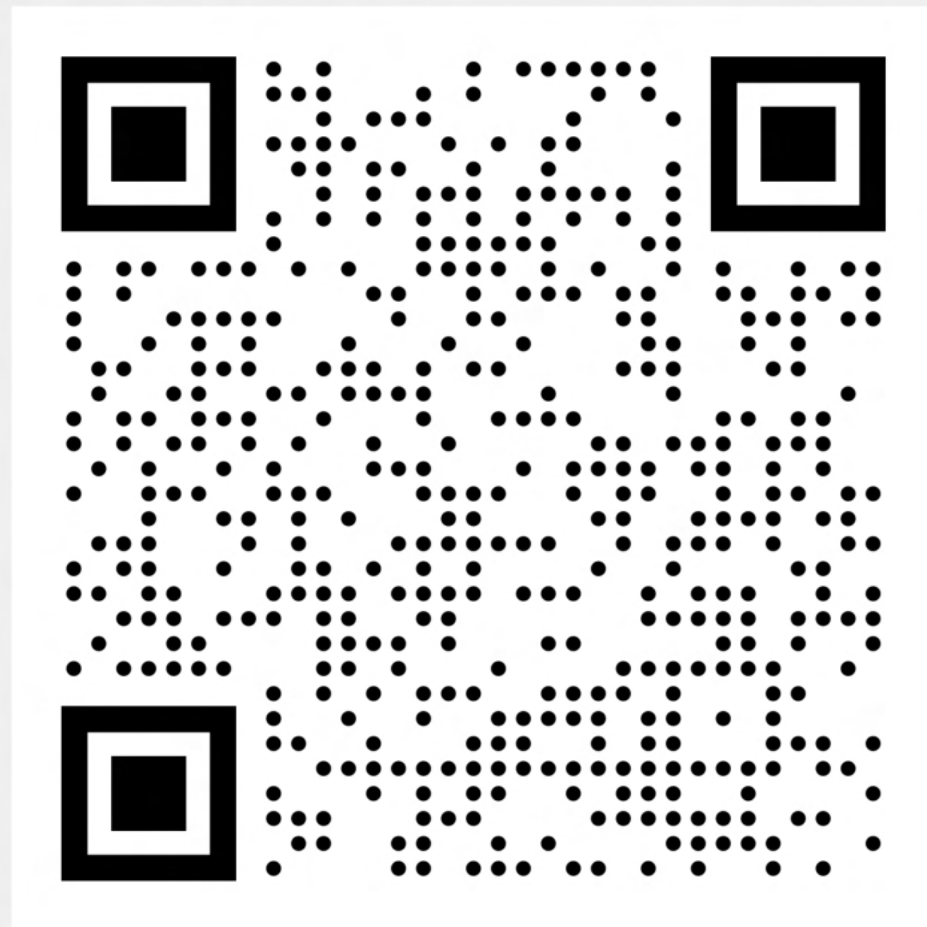
Dive Deeper into Your Enneagram Type

Explore & Understand: Deep Dive into Your Type

Ready to explore the depths of your personality type? Visit the website linked below to delve into detailed descriptions, growth paths, and insights for each Enneagram type.

Truity.com

Scan the link to begin your journey of self-exploration and personal growth.





5

Conclusion

Applying the Enneagram in Everyday Life

**Bring it
Home**

Key Takeaways

Self-Awareness: Use your Enneagram type to understand your core motivations and how they influence your decisions and relationships.

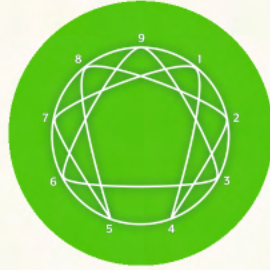
Communication: Tailor your communication strategies based on your type and the types of those around you for more effective interactions.

Growth: Identify areas for personal development and set actionable goals tailored to your Enneagram type.

Empathy: Recognize and appreciate the diverse perspectives and motivations of others based on their Enneagram types.

Final Thought

"The Enneagram serves as a powerful tool, not only for self-exploration but also for enhancing our capacity for empathy and understanding. It opens our eyes to the diverse perspectives of others, enriching our connections and fostering a deeper comprehension of our own paths."



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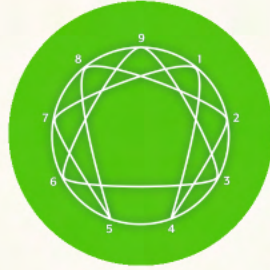


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Applying the Enneagram in Everyday Life

Bring it Home





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An Adventure into
the Enneagram

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5 Conclusion

Applying the Enneagram in Everyday Life

Bring it Home





Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child and Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	3
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Month of Military Child Classroom Kits

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...

I am including these documents in my professional portfolio because they support my ability to conduct community and educational outreach.

The articles included in the Month of the Military Child (MOMC) Classroom Kit offer a convenient and accessible means for community members to gain insight into the experiences of military children.

The objective and procedure behind these kits are straightforward. Parents of military children visit our website, iowacyp.com, navigate to our Classroom Kit page, and register for a kit. Subsequently, the kits are distributed to the SFRS teams statewide in Iowa, who then provide a pick up time for parents and then the kits are taken to schools by military children. This initiative provides educators with resources to facilitate discussions and enhance understanding of military children.

Comprising student wristbands, a teacher's water bottle, informational fliers about the Child and Youth Program, promotional materials for PurpleUp!, and a letter to educators detailing the contents and suggestions for utilization, the MOMC Classroom Kit serves as a comprehensive resource.

The MOMC Classroom Kits, provided by the Child and Youth Program, serve as an effective means to promote awareness of the program within the community while fostering understanding and support for military children.



Support Iowa's 9,000
Military Youth by wearing
purple on the second
Friday in April.

Find out ways to participate:
WWW.IOWACY.PCOM

#iapurpleup



MOMC

MONTH OF THE MILITARY CHILD

What is MOMC?

April is nationally recognized as the Month of the Military Child (MOMC). This month-long celebration began in 1986 as a time to honor the important role military youth play in the armed forces community. During this month we applaud Military Families and their children for the daily sacrifices they make and the challenges they overcome.

Why Awareness for Military Youth?

- To empower them to be resilient.
- To help them create community in their lives for when their loved ones are away for extended time.
- To honor their sacrifice to our country.
- To help the Soldier (they can focus on their mission better when they know their family is taken care of at home).

How Do I Participate?

- Wear purple, the color chosen to represent all service branches in the Military, on the second Friday in April.
- Share photos via social media with the hashtag #IApurpleup
- Share the flyers to your community, or school.
- Share the purple bracelets to your class or office.

WWW.IOWACYP.COM

#IApurpleup

month of the **MILITARY CHILD**



Wear purple on
the second Friday in
April



Contact us about our
MOMC promo kits



Change your profile
photo on social media
to our PurpleUP jpeg



Learn more about
military-youth culture



Find out how many
people around you have
a military connection

FIVE ways to
show your support

Go to www.iowacy.com for more information
or contact us at iaarngcyp@gmail.com



Dear Teacher,

Thank you for supporting the Month of the Military Child (MOMC) and the Purple Up Initiative.

Your Purple Up Promotion Kit includes:

MOMC Flyers: To promote awareness within your school and classroom. Purple Wristbands: For your students to wear, symbolizing support for military children. A Water Bottle: A token of our appreciation for your dedication, meant specifically for you.

Utilizing Your Kit:

1. Spread Awareness: Use the flyers to educate students about the significance of MOMC and the challenges military children face.
2. Prepare for Purple Up Day: Encourage wearing purple and the wristbands on the second Friday of April. Integrate themes of resilience and community into your lessons.
3. Social Media Challenge: Share a photo of your class wearing purple with #IApurpleup to participate in the nationwide support movement.
4. Discussion and Reflection: Discuss the importance of supporting military families, using the materials as conversation starters.
5. Broaden the Impact: Extend the awareness to the wider school community to maximize support.

Your engagement makes a significant difference in recognizing and supporting military children. We're excited to see how you use this kit to create a meaningful impact.

With gratitude,

Chris Cox
Lead Child & Youth Program Coordinator
Army National Guard Contractor

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Chris Cox".



Discussion Questions:

1. Understanding Military Life: What are some challenges military families might face that differ from civilian families? How do frequent moves, deployments, and the general uncertainty of military life affect children?
2. The Importance of Support: Why do you think initiatives like the Purple Up Initiative are important for military children? How do gestures of support from the community make a difference in their lives?
3. Symbolism of Purple: Why do you think the color purple was chosen to represent support for military children? What does wearing purple on Purple Up Day signify to you and to others?
(Answer: Purple represents all branches of the military)
4. Resilience and Community: How do military children demonstrate resilience? Discuss ways in which schools and communities can help build a supportive environment for them.
5. Extending Awareness: Beyond wearing purple, what are some other ways we can show support to military children throughout the year? How can social media be used to broaden the impact of initiatives like MOMC?

Reflection Prompts:

1. Personal Connection: Reflect on any personal experiences or connections you have with the military. How do these experiences shape your understanding of the challenges faced by military families?
2. Empathy Exercise: Imagine being a military child who moves frequently. Write a short essay or journal entry about how you would feel having to adapt to new schools and make new friends often.
3. Community Impact: Think about the impact of the entire school participating in the Purple Up Initiative. How does collective action contribute to a stronger sense of community and support?
4. Action Plan: Consider what actions you can take, both big and small, to support military children in your school or community. This could range from a kind gesture to organizing an awareness event.
5. Reflecting on Resilience: After discussing the resilience demonstrated by military children, reflect on a time you faced a challenge and how you overcame it. How does resilience help us in difficult situations?



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 3, 4, 7, 8
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Partnership Portfolio

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

... it exemplifies my capacity to forge and maintain strategic partnerships that significantly enhance the support systems for military families and children through the Child and Youth Services (CYS) programs. This Comprehensive Partnership Portfolio documents the collaborative relationships I have developed with diverse organizations, including Iowa Select Farms, Capitol City Church, EveryStep, The Iowa National Guard Officers Auxiliary, Support Siouxland Soldiers, and Grandview Christian Schools. It showcases my adeptness in identifying synergistic opportunities, negotiating mutually beneficial agreements, and ensuring the continuity and growth of these collaborations. The portfolio highlights the tangible outcomes of these partnerships, such as enhanced programming, increased resources, and broader community engagement, demonstrating my commitment to leveraging community assets for the betterment of ARNG families. By including this artifact, I aim to illustrate my strategic approach to partnership development, my skills in effective communication and negotiation, and my dedication to creating a supportive ecosystem that fosters the well-being and resilience of military-connected youth.

OUR PARTNERSHIPS



Iowa Select Farms, an organization eager to support military families in Iowa, they donated the take home activities and meals.



Capitol City Church assembled a team of volunteers to support and bake for our holiday events.



EveryStep provided amazing resources during our annual Iowa Remembers Retreat for military youth who have lost a loved one.



The Iowa National Guard Officers Auxiliary offered scholarships for our youth as well as supported the Iowa CYP with various donations for youth programming.



Support Siouxland Soldiers provided programming with a similar mission for military families and collaborated with the Iowa CYP and Iowa STP in their efforts to make these events possible.



Grandview Christian Schools contributed to our events by sending students to serve and facilitate activities. In addition, they built resource kits to support our military families.



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child and Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	5
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Volunteer Process: Emails for Volunteer Recruitment

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

I am including the following documents as artifacts in my professional portfolio because this shows the process of the ability to recruit, train and retain individual and group volunteers.

These documents provide a detailed roadmap for our volunteers, delineating each step of the process. Initially, we initiate contact with individuals and organizations via email (Artifact #1), gauging their interest and preferred level of involvement. Subsequently, we dispatch a second email containing our volunteer application, handbook, and background check information upon indication of interest (Artifact #2). Upon receipt of all requisite materials, a third email is dispatched confirming completion of forms and soliciting a time for a Zoom Call interview (Artifact #3). The agenda for the Zoom Call/Interview is attached as well, walking through the call and what will be asked and conversations/ questions (Artifact #4) Following the interviews , a follow-up email is sent, assuring volunteers that they will be apprised of forthcoming volunteer opportunities(Artifact #5). This allows us to stay in contact and communicate with our volunteers, keeping them in the know of opportunities for them to make a difference.

INITIAL VOLUNTEER EMAIL TO ORGANIZATIONS

STEP 1

DRAFT EMAIL

SUBJECT: Opportunity to Make a Difference: Volunteer with Army National Guard Child and Youth Program

Dear [Organizations Name],

I hope this email finds you well. My name is [Your name], and I am reaching out on behalf of the Army National Guard Child and Youth Program. Our mission is to help military youth thrive, and we do that through the avenues of providing engaging events, helpful educational resources, and community outreach.

As we strive to achieve our mission and make a positive impact in the lives of military youth, we are constantly seeking passionate individuals and organizations to join us in our efforts. It is with this in mind that I am reaching out to you today.

We offer a variety of volunteer opportunities, ranging from administrative responsibilities, set and tear down for events, or working with youth at an event. These opportunities can be tailored to fit skill, interest, and availability of those who are interested.

Volunteering with us not only provides an opportunity for those to give back to military families and their youth along with offering an opportunity to make a lasting impact in the lives of military youth.

1. (potential business partnership) I would love to discuss how we can further collaborate and explore potential opportunities for a partnership. Please let me know if you would be interested in setting up a meeting to discuss this further or if you have any questions.

2. (potential university partnership) If there is an opportunity, volunteer fair, etc to be able to show/ explain to the students of [university name] what we do and opportunities for them to be involved and volunteer, please let us know! We would love to inform students of opportunities for them to make an impact for military youth.

Thank you for considering this opportunity and I look forward to the possibility of partnering together to make a difference in the lives of military youth.

From,
[ARNG CYP Sta]

PRE-APPLICATION EMAIL
STEP 2
EMAIL DRAFT

SUBJECT: Volunteering Next Steps

Dear [Organization/ Name],

I hope this email finds you well. My name is [Your name], and I am reaching out on behalf of the Army National Guard Child and Youth Program. I wanted to say thank you for your interest in volunteering for this program. We are excited to have you partner alongside us, help military youth, and make an impact!

Listed below are links for the next steps for you to take in the volunteer process. This process should only take about 10-20 minutes, so thank you for your time in filling out these forms:

- State Background Check
- [Volunteer Interest Form](#)

If you have any questions, please let us know. Again, we appreciate your interest and efforts to make a difference in the lives of Military Youth.

Best Regards,

[Your Name]

**POST APPLICATION
STEP 3
EMAIL DRAFT**

SUBJECT: Thank you for Your Interest & Volunteer Interview Zoom
time Sign-up

Dear [Organization Name/ Individual Name]

I hope this email finds you well. I wanted to say thank you for expressing interest in volunteering with the Army National Guard Child and Youth Program. Your willingness to be involved means a great deal to us, and we are excited about the potential collaboration ahead.

To take the next step, if you have not already, please fill out the form in the link below along with the form for the state background check.

If you have already done that, the next step is to set up a volunteer interview via Zoom. This interview will provide an opportunity for us to get to know each other better, discuss your interests and skills, and share more with you about the Child and Youth Program.

Please select a time below:

- Time #1
- Time #2
- Time #3

If any of those time slots work for you, please reply to this email with the time that works best for you. We will then send a calendar invitation with the Zoom link along with meeting details.

If none of these times work for you, please let us know, and we will do our best to find another time.

Thank you again for your interest and support, we are looking forward to

meeting with you and discussing how we can work together to impact the lives of military kids.

From,
[Your name]

Agenda for Volunteer Zoom Call

Volunteer Process

Meeting time: 15-20 minutes

INTRODUCTION (3-5 minutes)

- Introduce yourself (name, position, how long you have been in the position, and anything else about yourself)
- Ask them about themselves (name, where they are located in the state, what they like to do, etc.)
 - Also ask about interests for volunteering (refer to form if already filled out, if not ask them what interests them)

SHARE ABOUT THE PROGRAM

- Who is CYP?
 - Mission: The Mission of the Army National Guard (ARNG) Child and Youth Program (CYP) is to promote and sustain the quality of life and resilience of ARNG-dependent children and youth by providing secure, timely, flexible, high-quality support service and enrichment services.
 - Vision: We exist to impact the culture of military youth in Iowa so that their families thrive in the face of challenges.
 - Purpose: The purpose of the ARNG CYP is to support the readiness and resilience of geographically dispersed Army Soldiers and their families through age-appropriate youth programming within the program's core elements by reducing the conflict between parental responsibilities and mission requirements
- Opportunities to make a difference
 - Military Family Event: These are events we hold in every region of the state to have an opportunity for youth and families to connect locally and build relationship with each other
 - Opportunities to connect with kids, share about what we do, etc.
 - Yellow Ribbon: Yellow Ribbon events are opportunities we have to support Yellow Ribbon events and have an opportunity to provide curriculum for kids while their parents participate in a Yellow Ribbon briefing. This is an all day event where we have the opportunity to provide a curriculum that can help the youth and kids grow in resiliency, and help them understand they are not alone and have the skills to move forward.
 - Opportunity to do crafts, engage with youth, help facilitate learning opportunities, etc
 - Annual Events: Every year there are events that we host and we typically need a lot of volunteers to make them happen. Some events that we have are Military Family Ball, Family Fall Festival, Cookies with Santa, and more! These events

- require a lot of help, with set up to tear down, crafts, helping with kids, etc.
 - Family Fall Festival, Cookies with Santa, etc.
 - Opportunities to do crafts, event set up, event tear down, engage with kids, arts and crafts, etc.
- Other: If you are interested in Administrative tasks, we will opportunities for that around the year (boxes for MOMC, stung envelopes for Military Family Ball, etc)
- Important Information:
 - Safety Information:
 - Child Abuse Prevention
 - Touch Policy
 - Discipline Policy
 - Sta Ratios
 - Administering Medication
 - Dress Code:
 - Dress modestly, appropriately, and practically
 - Professional and respectful appearance
 - Clothing that does not pertains/ depicts substances or activities of an illegal nature, profanity, suggestive, inappropriate language, or violence -
- Language
 - Communication is a powerful tool, we encourage volunteers to use language that is appropriate, fosters encouragement, positivity, and support
 - Language that does not do such will not be tolerated and respectfully asked not to use around children/ youth
 - Refer to the Volunteer Manual for more details about each of these topics

OTHER DETAILS/ LAST COMMENTS

- Share with them resources:
 - Volunteer Manual, website, etc.
- Any extra steps that need to be taken to complete the volunteer process
- Any questions?
- We will reach out when there is an opportunity!

**POST ZOOM CALL
STEP 4
EMAIL DRAFT**

SUBJECT: Volunteer Process Completed

Dear [Organization/ Name],

I hope this email finds you well. On behalf of the Child and Youth Program, thank you for your time and diligence with completing the volunteer process! We are so excited for you to use your passions and skills to serve and help military youth.

Some of our events that we will need volunteers in the next coming months are listed below:

- Event #1
- Event #2
- Events #3

If any of these events interest you, or you are wondering if you could volunteer another way, please reach out and we would be happy to get you connected.

Thank you again and we look forward to our partnership to impact military youth together.

Best Regards,

[Your name]



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	CYS Event Marketing Plan Overview

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...it exemplifies my ability to design and maintain effective marketing plans for Child and Youth Services (CYS) events within the Army National Guard community. This detailed plan showcases my strategic approach to event promotion, from initial planning stages 180 days out through to post-event activities. It highlights my competence in leveraging technology, specifically Notion, to automate and manage tasks, ensuring each critical step in the event marketing process is executed efficiently and on time. The artifact demonstrates my skills in coordinating logistics, creating promotional materials, engaging with volunteers, and utilizing digital platforms for outreach, all essential components of successful event marketing. By detailing the structured timeline and the integration of Notion for task management, this marketing plan not only underscores my organizational skills but also my adaptability and innovative use of tools to enhance collaboration and achieve marketing objectives. This approach has proven effective in increasing event attendance, engagement, and overall satisfaction, thereby contributing to the continued growth and success of CYS programs.

CYS Event Marketing Plan Overview

This marketing plan outlines the steps to effectively promote Child and Youth Services (CYS) events, leveraging a structured timeline and utilizing Notion for task automation and management. By integrating strategic planning with targeted promotion, this plan ensures broad awareness and engagement for each event within the ARNG community.

Pre-Event Tasks

180 Days Out:

Location, Date, and Time: Secure and confirm the details of the event location, date, and time. This foundational step ensures all subsequent planning and promotion activities are aligned.

Documentation: Prepare and send necessary documents for The Adjutant General's (TAG) signature and submit senior leadership speaker requests to highlight the event's significance and secure high-profile engagements.

Logistics Planning: Initiate purchase requests for event supplies and create an Eventbrite page for online registration, setting the stage for public awareness and participation.

90 Days Out:

4. **Coordinate Details:** Finalize logistical details such as items needed, meals, and event specifics, ensuring a seamless attendee experience.

60 Days Out:

5. **Promotional Materials:** Design and create an event flyer and detailed agenda to inform potential attendees about the event's offerings.

Eventbrite Update: Enhance the Eventbrite page with a custom banner and include a post-event survey email for feedback. Determine and request support from the State Teen Panel (STP)/Volunteers.

30 Days Out:

7. **Promotion:** Amplify event visibility through Facebook posts, targeted email campaigns, and internal channels within the Well-Being Support Branch (WFSB).

Travel and Support Authorizations: Create travel authorizations for CYP staff and Issue Invitational Travel Orders (ITOs) for STP/Volunteers, confirming their support.

14 Days Out:

9. Final Preparations:

- Share detailed event information with STP/Volunteers.
- Prepare and upload attendee rosters to a shared drive.
- Pack necessary supplies, including check-in materials, rosters, and medical documents.
- Alert the Government Purchase Card (GPC) holder of upcoming procurement needs for the event.

Post-Event Tasks

Post-Event:

10. Evaluation and Outreach:

- Conduct an After Action Review (AAR) and update CYS information accordingly.
- Transfer new contact information to the email distribution list for future communications.
- Scan and store rosters/documents in a shared drive for record-keeping.

Multimedia Management:

- Download event photos, back them up on a hard drive, and upload them to Amazon Photos for safekeeping.
- Share select photos on Facebook to highlight the event's success and create a storyboard for a visual recap of the event.

Notion Integration for Task Management

- Utilize Notion to automate the creation of these tasks for each event, ensuring a standardized approach to event planning and marketing.
- Each phase (180/90/60/30/14 days out) will be set as a template with respective tasks, facilitating easy tracking, updates, and collaboration among the team.

- Integration with calendars and reminders in Notion will ensure timely execution of each step, allowing for real-time adjustments as needed.

Conclusion

This marketing plan, empowered by Notion's organizational capabilities, provides a comprehensive approach to promoting CYS events effectively. Through early planning, regular promotion, and post-event engagement, this strategy aims to maximize attendance, participation, and positive experiences for the ARNG community, fostering a supportive environment for military children and families.



**Army National Guard
Child and Youth Services**

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 3, 4, 7, 8
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Expansion and Growth of CYS Through Local Initiatives in Iowa

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE ...it encapsulates my dedication to the strategic and responsive growth of Child and Youth Services (CYS) through local initiatives across Iowa. This document highlights the methodical expansion of CYS programs from 2016 to the present, reflecting a sustained commitment to enhancing the accessibility and impact of services for Army National Guard (ARNG) youth and their families. It showcases a progression from initial data-driven analysis to identify key regions, through to the successful establishment of regional events in Sioux City, Waterloo, Davenport, Cedar Rapids, and Council Bluffs. Each phase of expansion, marked by specific years, illustrates a thoughtful approach to meeting the evolving needs of military families, underscored by an increase in budget allocation and strategic location adjustments. This artifact serves as a testament to my ability to lead growth initiatives, make data-informed decisions, and adapt strategies to maximize engagement and support for ARNG families. It demonstrates not just a commitment to the current well-being of military-connected children but also a forward-looking vision for continued growth and improvement of CYS programs through local initiatives.

Expansion and Growth of CYS Through Local Initiatives in Iowa

Executive Summary

This document highlights the strategic and data-driven expansion of Child and Youth Services (CYS) across Iowa from 2016 to the present. It outlines our phased approach to extending CYS programs to meet the needs of Army National Guard (ARNG) youth and their families in various regions, demonstrating a sustained commitment to accessibility and community support.

Phase 1: Initial Analysis and Establishment of Regional Events (2016)

- **2016:** Initiated a comprehensive data-gathering effort to identify where ARNG youth primarily reside within Iowa. Sioux City and Waterloo were identified as the top two populations centers for ARNG families.
- Established regional events in **Sioux City and Waterloo** to serve as accessible points for CYS programs, marking the beginning of our strategic regional expansion.

Phase 2: Budget Increase and Regional Expansion (2017-2018)

- **2017-2018:** Following the success of the initial events, we increased our budget to support further expansion.
- Launched CYS events in two additional locations, **Davenport and Dubuque**, thereby extending our reach and providing more families with access to our services.

Phase 3: Reevaluation and Strategic Relocation (2019-2020)

- **2019-2020:** Undertook a thorough evaluation of event locations based on participation data, feedback from ARNG families, and logistical considerations.
- Decided to replace **Dubuque** with **Cedar Rapids** due to the latter's higher potential for impact and engagement. Additionally, expanded our footprint to include **Council Bluffs**, adapting our strategy to better meet the needs of our community.

Current Status and Future Directions

- **2021-Present:** Continuously monitoring the effectiveness and reach of our regional events, with a focus on adaptability and responsiveness to the evolving needs of ARNG families.
- Looking ahead, we are committed to exploring further expansion opportunities, enhancing program offerings, and strengthening community partnerships to ensure comprehensive support for ARNG youth across Iowa.

Conclusion

The phased expansion of CYS across Iowa, from initial events in Sioux City and Waterloo to the strategic inclusion of Cedar Rapids and Council Bluffs, reflects our ongoing commitment to the ARNG community. By prioritizing data-driven decisions and community feedback, we have steadily grown our regional footprint, ensuring that ARNG youth and their families have access to supportive, enriching programs tailored to their unique needs. This document showcases our dedication to enhancing the lives of military families through sustained local initiatives and serves as a foundation for future growth and development within CYS.

-
- Integration with calendars and reminders in Notion will ensure timely execution of each step, allowing for real-time adjustments as needed.

Conclusion

This marketing plan, empowered by Notion's organizational capabilities, provides a comprehensive approach to promoting CYS events effectively. Through early planning, regular promotion, and post-event engagement, this strategy aims to maximize attendance, participation, and positive experiences for the ARNG community, fostering a supportive environment for military children and families.



**Army National Guard
Child and Youth Services**

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 2, 3, 8, 9, 11
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Yellow Ribbon Curriculum

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

... it highlights my deep understanding of working within the ARNG Community, as outlined in Competency 8. The development and implementation of this curriculum, aimed at supporting youth through the pre-deployment, deployment, and post-deployment phases, underscore my comprehensive grasp of the unique dynamics and challenges faced by military families. By proactively addressing the emotional and psychological needs of soldiers' children, this program directly contributes to easing the concerns soldiers may have about their families during periods of service, enabling them to focus more fully on their responsibilities. This initiative is a testament to my ability to navigate the complexities of military family life, developing programs that bolster soldier readiness and retention by fostering a supportive environment for their loved ones. My role in this curriculum's creation and execution demonstrates my commitment to improving the welfare of military families, reflecting a significant aspect of my professional expertise: a nuanced understanding of the ARNG Community's needs and the development of targeted support systems to meet these challenges. Through this work, I aim to reinforce the fabric of the military community, ensuring its members are supported, resilient, and cohesive.

YELLOW RIBBON DURING DEPLOYMENT

ASCEND THE SPACE

DURING TABLE OF CONTENTS

AGENDA	
MATERIAL LIST	
INTRO	
RECEPTION	
CLASSROOM CONTRACT	
ICEBREAKERS	
ENGINEERING CHALLENGE: TOWERS	
TEAM BUILDING	
BREAK OUT STATIONS.....	

AGENDA

DATE MONTH YEAR

OBJECTIVE

- A. Foster education, awareness, celebration, and outreach/surrounding military families.
- B. Support that promotes and sustains quality of life while building resilience and developing life skills

MATERIAL NEED

Item:
 Link:
 Price: \$
 QTY:
 Estimate: \$

TRAVEL

Origin: Name | Address, City, State, 12345
Destination(s): Name | Address, City, State, 12345
Virtual Platform: If any

AGENDA – LARGER GROUP

Day		
8:00am	Reception	Begin to build connections.
9:00	Introduction Classroom Contract Icebreakers	Develop student's connection.
10:00	Team Building	Outdoor Availability Dependent
11:00	Break	
11:15	Team Building Game	Code Names One Night Werewolf Switch
11:45	Lunch Multimedia	
1:30pm	Engineering Challenge	Towers
2:00	Card Making	
2:15	Break Out Stations	Card Making Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch

AGENDA – SMALLER GROUP

Day		
9:30am	Reception	Begin to build connections.
10:00	Introduction	Develop student's connection
	Classroom Contract	
	Icebreakers	
10:30	Team Building	Outdoor Availability Dependent
11:00	Engineering Challenge	Towers
11:45	Lunch	
	Multimedia	
1:30pm	Team Building Game	Code Names One Night Werewolf Switch
2:30	Break	
2:45	Card Making	
3:00	Break Out Stations	Card Making Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch

TEAM BUILDING ACTIVITIES

9-SQUARE	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
BADMINTON	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
BAGS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
CAPTURE THE FLAG	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
DODGE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT CHECKERS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT CHESS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT JENGA	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GROUP GUTTER CHALLENGE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR†	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
KAN-JAM	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
LADDER GOLF	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
OMNIKIN BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
O-RING AND CHAIN	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PARACHUTE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PICKLE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PLANK CHALLENGE BALANCE BOARDS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
ROPE GAMES BACKPACK	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
SLACK LINE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
SPIDERWEB	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
SPORTS BALLS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
TARP CHALLENGE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
WASHERS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
WHIFFLE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP

† Notates the activity can be modified to fit the category



MATERIAL LIST

GENERAL SUPPLY

- Name Tags
- Sharpies

ELECTRONICS

- Projector
- Laptop – or a device to connect to projector
- Speaker
- Cords
- Nintendo Switch and Accessories

ART KIT

- Pencil Sharpener
- Scissors
- Glue
- Art Coloring Books
- Construction Paper
- Paper
- Markers
- Colored Pencils
- Crayons

ART ACTIVITY

- Card stock- for cards

BOARD GAMES

- Uno
- Skip-Bo
- Deck of Card
- Bananagrams
- Code Names
- One Night Werewolf

SENSORY ITEMS

- Sensory Blocks
- Legos

ACTIVITY

- Circles (poly dots)
- Ice Breaker Wheelies
- Ice Breaker Thumb Balls

ACTIVITY SHEETS

- Personal Inventory Sheet
- Card Group Challenge Sheet

ENGINEERING ACTIVITY MATERIALS

- Tape Measure
- Straws
- Wooden Craft Sticks
- Tape
- Scissors
- Activity Balls (Thumb balls)

TEAM BUILDING EQUIPMENT- CHOOSE ACTIVITIES FROM AGENDA

Larger Group	Smaller Group
▪ 9-Square ▪ Badminton ▪ Bags ▪ Capture The Flag ▪ Dodge Ball ▪ Gutter Challenge ▪ Kan-Jam ▪ Ladder Golf ▪ Omnikin Ball ▪ Parachute ▪ Pickle Ball ▪ Plank Challenge ▪ Rope Games ▪ Slack Line ▪ Spiderweb ▪ Sports Balls ▪ Tarp Challenge ▪ Washers ▪ Whiffle Ball	▪ 9-Square ▪ Badminton ▪ Bags ▪ Dodge Ball ▪ Giant Checkers ▪ Giant Chess ▪ Giant Jenga ▪ Gutter Challenge ▪ Kan-Jam ▪ Ladder Golf ▪ O-Ring And Chain ▪ Plank Challenge ▪ Slack Line ▪ Spiderweb ▪ Sports Balls ▪ Washers

INTRODUCTION

OBJECTIVE

- Begin to build connections.

RECEPTION

- This is time for the teachers to get to know the participants. Make notes on things participants like, or do not like if you need to.

NAME TAG STATION

- First put your name on the name tag. Leave room to write something else on it later.

ART STATION

- Create art.

MIND GAMES STATION

- Play a quick game.

SCENARIO

INTRO (5 MINUTES)

- Ask the following question.
 - What brings you here today?
- Let them answer, and then go over why they are here. Respond to questions, and remember you are not a counselor but you can help them know there are others experiencing what they are going through.
- Answer:
 - Why we are here today (The teachers)?
 - Who is here?
 - Introduce the teaching team. Share a little about their experience.
 - What will we be doing?
 - "This is answered by our main Scenario for the day."
- Go into the Scenario.

SCENARIO (5 MINUTES)

"All of you are here because you are currently experiencing a deployment on the home front.

As we near closer to the end of the deployment, the remaining space of mission a loved one draws to an end. You are all here to complete Scenario: Ascend the Space, where you will engage in a series of waypoints "activities" designed to teach you the objectives (Connection, Awareness, Communication, Responsible Choice, and Caring) to ascend the deployment space.

This mission will require you to fully engage in the task at hand and in the end you will have built a tower of skills that will enable you to ascend the space."

INFO

Skill:

Time: 1 Hour

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Areas for each station
- Classroom discussion area

MATERIAL

- Construction Paper
- Markers
- Colored Pencils
- Crayons
- Board Games

SET UP

- One team member will oversee registration.
- Another team member will be prepping activities.
- **Art Station-** Set up paper, markers, and items for art.
- **Name Tag Station-** Set up name tags and a marker.
- **Mind Games Station-** Set up small board games.
- **Classroom Contract-** The teacher's paper outlines the following:
 - Self
 - Group
 - Class
 - Teacher

CLASSROOM CONTRACT

CONTRACT (15-30 MINUTES)

- “We have a mission to complete, and to complete this we need to work together as a group, as a class. In order to do this let's go over our Classroom Contract.”
- Split up into groups or stay together as a class. Ask these questions and have the students answer them out loud as a class or as a group on paper.
 - Identify Rules of Engagement
 - What do you expect from?
 - Example: Don't talk when they are talking
 - Self-
 - Example: Be kind
 - Group- (If there are enough students)
 - Example: Be kind
 - Class-
 - Example: Be respectful to everyone
 - Teachers-
 - Example: To learn from them, Make class fun
- If the groups answered them on paper, have them gather back at the Classroom Discussion Area. Ask each group to share what they wrote down.
 - One of the classroom leaders should be writing some of the answers that are said.
- Go over the new list and ask if everyone can agree to it.

ICEBREAKERS

OBJECTIVE

- Build connections and get to know each other.

LESSON PLAN

COMMONALITY CIRCLES (15 MINUTES)

- Have the participants place a foot on one poly dots. These poly dots should be placed in a circle.
 - There should be one poly dot for every participant, minus one.
- One participant will stand in the center.
- The person in the center will make a statement of something they have done or like.
 - I like to play or watch sports.
 - My favorite color is red.
 - I am wearing jeans.
- Once the statement is made, every participant that has that statement in common will move to a different poly dot.
 - They must move to a poly dot that is at least two away. It can't be next to them.
- One person will be left in the center. They will repeat the process.

ICEBREAKER THUMB BALL (15 MINUTES)

- Have the participants place a foot on one poly dots. These poly dots should be placed in a circle.
- Toss the ball. Once someone catches it, they will say their name then read the question where their thumb is located.
- Make sure that everyone gets a turn.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 15 – 30 Minutes

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do Icebreakers.

MATERIAL

- Circles (poly dots)
- Ice Breaker Wheelies
- Ice Breaker Thumb Ball

SET UP

- Have circle or poly dots ready for the students to grab.
- Have the thumb ball ready.

ENGINEERING ACTIVITY: TOWERS

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to communicate and work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

INTRODUCTION (2 MINUTES)

- Split into teams of 2-3.
- Go over the rules.
 - Make sure to identify where the tower should be built.
 - On tables, floors, etc.
 - Not against other objects.
 - Identify what materials will be used.
 - Tell the participants how to earn new material, if you decide to limit the material and make teams earn more.
 - Go over how the towers will be judged.
 - Tallest
 - Coolest looking
 - The teams can go for both if they want an extra challenge.

PLANNING PHASE (15 MINUTES)

- Have the teams get together to draw a plan for their tower on paper.

BUILD PHASE (>45 MINUTES)

- The teams can use the activity balls (thumb balls), or playing cards activity, to gain more material.
 - Have the team tell you what material they want before the activity to earn more material.
 - The whole team must do whatever it says to earn all their materials.

TEST PHASE (15 MINUTES)

- Once all teams are done the test phase will begin.
- The towers will be judge in two ways.
 - Tallest
 - Coolest looking

INFO

- Skill:** Teamwork, comm.
Time: 30 Mins – 1 Hour
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do activity.

MATERIAL

- Tape measure
- Straws
- Wooden Craft Sticks
- Tape
- Scissors
- Activity Balls (Thumb balls)

SET UP

- Make sure all material is accessible.
- Pass out starting material, but not too much. They need to earn some more.

TEAM BUILDING

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

BULL RING (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- Have the students work together to pull all the strings out like a sunshine.
- Once the bull ring is laid out, place the ball in the center of the ring.
- Place the cup somewhere at the opposite side of the room.
- Students will work together to pick up the ball and transport it using the bull ring.
 - They must only hold the ends of the string. No creeping up.
 - If they drop the ball they must start over.
 - They are not allowed to touch the ball at any time except to place it back on the ring.

STRINGS & TUBE (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- This is like the Bull Ring. It is just using different materials.

STRINGS & HOOK (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- This is generally the most challenging one. Only do this if the students are doing the other two well. This is also like the Bull Ring, but uses a hook to pick up a hooked block.
- The final challenge is using the string and hook to pick up a mouse trap without setting it off. The students will need to figure out where to pick up the trap without triggering it.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 1 Hour

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do team building.

MATERIAL

- Rope Games Backpack (Includes)
- Bull ring & Cup
- Strings & Tube set
- Strings & Hook set
- Block with hooks
- Tennis Balls
- Stand for the ball
- Various sized balls
- Mouse trap
- Ropes

SET UP

- Have an area large enough for the classroom to circle up, and move
- Lay the Bull Ring, Strings and Tube, or Strings and Hook out
- If it's the Strings and Tube set place the ball holder on the ground
- Help the students grab the ends of the strings

BREAKOUT STATIONS

OBJECTIVE

- Take some time to connect with like-minded individuals to build a sense of community.

LESSON PLAN

CARD MAKING STATION

- Make a card for your loved one, or just make some art.

SENSORY STATION

- Use sensory items for those that need to stay calm and keep their hands and minds busy.

CHILL STATION

- Need a break to yourself? Or do you just want to talk to some of the other students? This is the place.

GAME STATION

- Find someone to play a game and stretch your mind.
- This is a good time to play a game with a new friend.

NINTENDO SWITCH STATION

- Set ground rules.
- Let students take turns.

INFO

Skill: Connection
Time: 1 Hours or More
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Indoor

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do stations.

MATERIAL

- Construction Paper
- Paper
- Markers
- Crayons
- Colored Pencils
- Scissors
- Sensory blocks
- Board Games
- Card Stock- for cards
- Nintendo Switch & Accessories

SET UP

- Card Making Station
- Sensory Station
- Chill Station
 - This area should be clear of other objects.
- Game Section
- Nintendo Switch Station

YELLOW RIBBON PRE DEPLOYMENT

STRONG TOGETHER

DURING TABLE OF CONTENTS

AGENDA
MATERIAL LIST
INTRO
 RECEPTION
 CLASSROOM CONTRACT
ICEBREAKERS
HUNT THE GOOD STUFF
TEAM BUILDING
PARACORD BRACELETS
ENGINEERING CHALLENGE: BRIDGE
BREAK OUT STATIONS.....

AGENDA

DATE MONTH YEAR

OBJECTIVE

- A. Foster education, awareness, celebration, and outreach/surrounding military families.
- B. Support that promotes and sustains quality of life while building resilience and developing life skills

AGENDA – LARGER GROUP

Day		
8:00am	Reception	Begin to build connections.
9:00	Introduction Classroom Contract Icebreakers	Develop student's connection.
10:00	Hunt the Good Stuff	Give journals to keep throughout the Deployment
10:30	Break	
10:45	Team Building	Outdoor Availability Dependent
11:45	Lunch	
	Team Building Game	Code Names One Night Werewolf Other Board Games
12:15pm	Paracord Bracelets	The Power of many can be Strong Together
1:30	Engineering Challenge	Bridge
2:30	Break Out Stations	Card Making Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch

AGENDA – SMALLER GROUP

Day		
8:00am	Reception	Begin to build connections.
9:00	Introduction Classroom Contract Icebreakers	Develop student's connection.
9:30	Hunt the Good Stuff	Give journals to keep throughout the Deployment
10:00	In-Motion / Optional	Statue in the Gard, Ultimate Ninja, Coin Kit
10:30	Break	
10:45	Team Building	Outdoor Availability Dependent
11:45	Lunch	
	Team Building Game	Code Names One Night Werewolf Other Board Games
12:15pm	Paracord Bracelets	The Power of many can be Strong Together
1:15	Engineering Challenge	Bridge
2:15	Break Out Stations	Card Making Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch

TEAM BUILDING ACTIVITIES

9-SQUARE	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
BADMINTON	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
BAGS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
CAPTURE THE FLAG	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
DODGE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT CHECKERS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT CHESS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT JENGA	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GROUP GUTTER CHALLENGE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR†	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
KAN-JAM	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
LADDER GOLF	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
OMNIKIN BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
O-RING AND CHAIN	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PARACHUTE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PICKLE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PLANK CHALLENGE BALANCE BOARDS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
ROPE GAMES BACKPACK	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
SLACK LINE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
SPIDERWEB	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
SPORTS BALLS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
TARP CHALLENGE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
WASHERS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
WHIFFLE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP

† Notates the activity can be modified to fit the category

MATERIAL LIST

GENERAL SUPPLY

- Name Tags
- Sharpies

ELECTRONICS

- Projector
- Laptop – or a device to connect to projector
- Speaker
- Cords
- Nintendo Switch and Accessories

ART KIT

- Pencil Sharpener
- Scissors
- Glue
- Art Coloring Books
- Construction Paper
- Paper
- Markers
- Colored Pencils
- Crayons

ART ACTIVITY

- Card stock- for cards

BOARD GAMES

- Uno
- Skip-Bo
- Deck of Card
- Bananagrams
- Code Names
- One Night Werewolf

SENSORY ITEMS

- Sensory Blocks
- Legos

ACTIVITY

- Circles (poly dots)
- Ice Breaker Wheelies
- Ice Breaker Thumb Balls
- Journals
- Markers
- Pens/Pencils

PARACORD BRACELET KIT

- Paracord – Different Colors
- Plastic Buckles
- Ruler
- Scissors
- Lighter

ACTIVITY SHEETS

- Personal Inventory Sheet
- Card Group Challenge Sheet
- Hunt the Good Stuff Worksheet (If No Journals)

ENGINEERING ACTIVITY MATERIALS

- Bowls
- Marbles
- Tape Measure
- Straws
- Wooden Craft Sticks
- Tape
- Scissors
- Activity Balls (Thumb balls)

TEAM BUILDING EQUIPMENT- CHOOSE ACTIVITIES FROM AGENDA

Larger Group	Smaller Group
▪ 9-Square ▪ Badminton ▪ Bags ▪ Capture The Flag ▪ Dodge Ball ▪ Gutter Challenge ▪ Kan-Jam ▪ Ladder Golf ▪ Omnikin Ball ▪ Parachute ▪ Pickle Ball ▪ Plank Challenge ▪ Rope Games ▪ Slack Line ▪ Spiderweb ▪ Sports Balls ▪ Tarp Challenge ▪ Washers ▪ Whiffle Ball	▪ 9-Square ▪ Badminton ▪ Bags ▪ Dodge Ball ▪ Giant Checkers ▪ Giant Chess ▪ Giant Jenga ▪ Gutter Challenge ▪ Kan-Jam ▪ Ladder Golf ▪ O-Ring And Chain ▪ Plank Challenge ▪ Slack Line ▪ Spiderweb ▪ Sports Balls ▪ Washers

INTRODUCTION

OBJECTIVE

- Begin to build connections.

RECEPTION

- This is time for the teachers to get to know the participants. Make notes on things participants like, or do not like if you need to.

NAME TAG STATION

- First put your name on the name tag. Leave room to write something else on it later.

ART STATION

- Create art.

MIND GAMES STATION

- Play a quick game.

SCENARIO

INTRO (5 MINUTES)

- Ask the following question.
 - What brings you here today?
- Let them answer, and then go over why they are here. Respond to questions, and remember you are not a counselor, but you can help them know there are others experiencing what they are going through.
- Answer:
 - Why we are here today (The teachers)?
 - Who is here?
 - Introduce the teaching team. Share a little about their experience.
 - What will we be doing?
 - "This is answered by our main Scenario for the day."
- Go into the Scenario.

SCENARIO (5 MINUTES)

"All of you are here because you are currently experiencing a deployment on the home front.

The soldier is leaving, and let's talk about the elephant in the room. It's ok to talk and learn to cope with this big change. How will you do this? You will learn why it is better to have others around you that understand what you are going through. You are stronger together."

INFO

Skill:

Time: 1 Hour

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Areas for each station
- Classroom discussion area

MATERIAL

- Construction Paper
- Markers
- Colored Pencils
- Crayons
- Board Games

SET UP

- One team member will oversee registration.
- Another team member will be prepping activities.
- **Art Station-** Set up paper, markers, and items for art.
- **Name Tag Station-** Set up name tags and a marker.
- **Mind Games Station-** Set up small board games.
- **Classroom Contract-** The teacher's paper outlines the following:
 - Self
 - Group
 - Class
 - Teacher

CLASSROOM CONTRACT

CONTRACT (15-30 MINUTES)

- “We have a mission to complete, and to complete this we need to work together as a group, as a class. In order to do this lets go over our Classroom Contract.”
- Split up into groups or stay together as a class. Ask these questions and have the students answer them out loud as a class or as a group on paper.
 - Identify Rules of Engagement
 - What do you expect from?
 - Example: Don’t talk when they are talking
 - Self-
 - Example: Be kind
 - Group- (If there are enough students)
 - Example: Be kind
 - Class-
 - Example: Be respectful to everyone
 - Teachers-
 - Example: To learn from them, Make class fun
- If the groups answered them on paper, have them gather back at the Classroom Discussion Area. Ask each group to share what they wrote down.
 - One of the classroom leaders should be writing some of the answers that are said.
- Go over the new list and ask if everyone can agree to it.

ICEBREAKERS

OBJECTIVE

- Build connections and get to know each other.

LESSON PLAN

COMMONALITY CIRCLES (15 MINUTES)

- Have the participants place a foot on one poly dots. These poly dots should be placed in a circle.
 - There should be one poly dot for every participant, minus one.
- One participant will stand in the center.
- The person in the center will make a statement of something they have done or like.
 - I like to play or watch sports.
 - My favorite color is red.
 - I am wearing jeans.
- Once the statement is made, every participant that has that statement in common will move to a different poly dot.
 - They must move to a poly dot that is at least two away. It can't be next to them.
- One person will be left in the center. They will repeat the process.

ICEBREAKER THUMB BALL (15 MINUTES)

- Have the participants place a foot on one poly dots. These poly dots should be placed in a circle.
- Toss the ball. Once someone catches it, they will say their name then read the question where their thumb is located.
- Make sure that everyone gets a turn.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 15 – 30 Minutes

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do Icebreakers.

MATERIAL

- Circles (poly dots)
- Ice Breaker Wheelies
- Ice Breaker Thumb Ball

SET UP

- Have circle or poly dots ready for the students to grab.
- Have the thumb ball ready.

HUNT THE GOOD STUFF

OBJECTIVE

- Bring awareness of positive and negative emotions.

LESSON PLAN

INTRO (2 MINUTES)

- You will feel different emotions that come and go when your loved one deploys. This is normal and you have others around you that may feel the same.
- Let's think this through.
 - First you will find out what are different emotions,
 - Second you will come up with positive things that happen throughout your day.
- Once these two things are done you can plan what to do when these emotions come out.

ACTIVITY (10 – 15 MINUTES)

- If the participants are younger, you may adapt the activity with an alternate part.
- An additional large sheet of paper may be needed.

Part 1

- In groups, have the participants write down positive and negative emotions on the large paper.
- Once everyone is complete have the groups share what they have written down.
- IF YOU HAVE YOUNGER PARTICIPANTS PROCEED TO ALTERNATE ACTIVITY AT THIS POINT.

Part 2

- Now, have the participants take their journal and begin writing down three good things that happened to them today, or yesterday.
 - If a journal isn't available, you can use the attached worksheet.

Part 3

- Once the student is done writing three good things have the students write a reflection next to each positive event that is listed.
 - Have them answer the following during the reflection:
 - Why this good thing happened?
 - What this good thing means to you.
 - What you can do tomorrow to enable more of this good thing.
 - What ways you or others contribute to this good thing.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 15 – 30 Minutes

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to write.

MATERIAL

- Large Sheets of Paper
- Markers
- Journals
- Writing Utensils
- Hunt the Good Stuff Worksheet (attached)

SET UP

- Ensure everyone has a notebook and writing utensil.
- Distribute a large sheet of paper and marker for every group.

DEBRIEF (5 – 15 MINUTES)

- Ask the participants to gather at the class discussion area.
- Have them share some of the good things that happened, and their reflection.
- Have them share how they felt during the activity at the beginning and then at the end.
- Discuss the positives/advantages of knowing why the good thing happened and what it means.
 - Finding out what is good beats the Bad (or Negativity Bias)- the way you pay more attention to bad events than positive events-
 - A tool to help remember the good is by making a habit to write or draw three good things in a journal.

ACTIVITY ALTERNATE (10 – 15 MINUTES)

Part 2- Alternate

- Now, in groups have the participants discuss good things that happened to them today, or yesterday. Write three of these on the large sheet of paper.

DERIEF ALTERNATE (5 – 15 MINUTES)

- Ask the participants to gather at the class discussion area.
 - Have the groups share what they wrote and then discuss as a class the following questions.
(Depending on time, you may need to have the groups share just one thing)
 - Why this good thing happened?
 - What this good thing means to you.
 - What you can do tomorrow to enable more of this good thing.
 - What ways you or others contribute to this good thing.
- Discuss the positives of knowing why the good thing happened and what it means.
 - Finding out what is good beats the Bad (or Negativity Bias)- the way you pay more attention to bad events than positive events-
 - A tool to help remember the good is by making a habit to write or draw three good things in a journal.

HUNT THE GOOD STUFF SHEET

INSTRUCTIONS

- Record three good things. Next to each positive event that you list, write a reflection (at least one sentence) about:
 - Why this good thing happened
 - What this good thing means to you
 - What you can do tomorrow to enable more of this good thing
 - What ways you or others contribute to this good thing

GOOD THING 1

REFLECTION

GOOD THING 2

REFLECTION

GOOD THING 3

REFLECTION

TEAM BUILDING

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

BULL RING (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- Have the students work together to pull all the strings out like a sunshine.
- Once the bull ring is laid out, place the ball in the center of the ring.
- Place the cup somewhere at the opposite side of the room.
- Students will work together to pick up the ball and transport it using the bull ring.
 - They must only hold the ends of the string. No creeping up.
 - If they drop the ball they must start over.
 - They are not allowed to touch the ball at any time except to place it back on the ring.

STRINGS & TUBE (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- This is like the Bull Ring. It is just using different materials.

STRINGS & HOOK (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- This is generally the most challenging one. Only do this if the students are doing the other two well. This is also like the Bull Ring, but uses a hook to pick up a hooked block.
- The final challenge is using the string and hook to pick up a mouse trap without setting it off. The students will need to figure out where to pick up the trap without triggering it.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 1 Hour

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do team building.

MATERIAL

- Rope Games Backpack (Includes)
- Bull ring & Cup
- Strings & Tube set
- Strings & Hook set
- Block with hooks
- Tennis Balls
- Stand for the ball
- Various sized balls
- Mouse trap
- Ropes

SET UP

- Have an area large enough for the classroom to circle up, and move
- Lay the Bull Ring, Strings and Tube, or Strings and Hook out
- If it's the Strings and Tube set place the ball holder on the ground
- Help the students grab the ends of the strings

PARACORD BRACELETS

OBJECTIVE

- Develop student's art, fine motor skills, and community.

LESSON PLAN

ACTIVITY

1. Share how the many different strands of the paracord can't hold much on their own, but together they can do great things. This is a great example of how community is so important to stay strong and do great things.
2. Choose your color.
3. Measure your wrist.
4. Wrap a length of paracord around your wrist, noting where the end hits the cord.



5. Measure the length with a ruler.



6. Measure out cord.
 - If you are using one color for your bracelet, multiply the number of inches in Step 2 (your wrist circumference) by 12.
 - If you are using two colors, multiply that number by 6. This calculation will give you the total number of inches you will need for your length of cord.
 - In our example, we ended up with 45 inches for each of the two colors we will be using ($7.5 \times 6 = 45$).

INFO

Skill: Art, Community
Time: 30 Minutes – 1 Hour
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- An area to do the activity.

MATERIAL

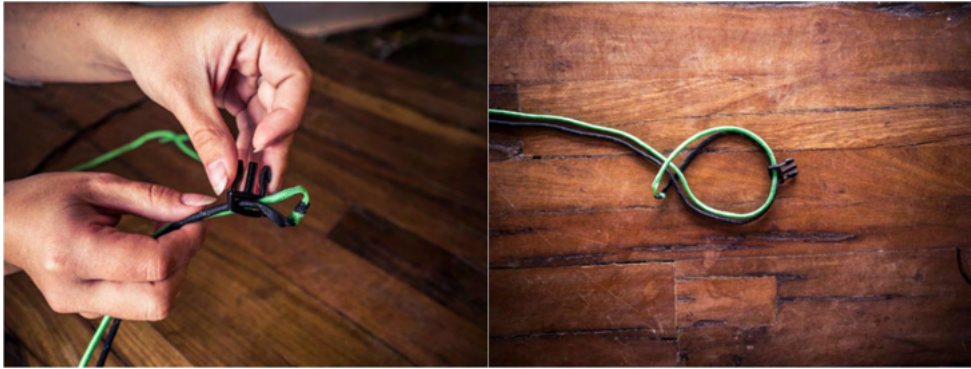
- Paracord
- Plastic Buckles
- Ruler
- Scissors
- Lighter

SET UP

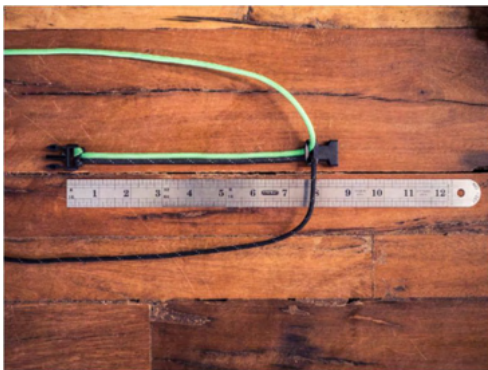
- Set the blocks out that will be used.

6. Attach paracord to buckle.
7. To attach the cord to one of the buckle ends (either buckle piece works), use a girth hitch.

HERE IS HOW:



- Thread the loose ends through the loop and pull the cord snug against the buckle.
8. Determine bracelet length.



9. Thread the dangling free ends of the cord through the other buckle piece.
 - Measuring from one buckle to the other (excluding the male prongs), position the free buckle so the bracelet length equals your wrist measurement plus one inch.
 - Our initial length was 7.5 in., so we wanted our bracelet to be 8.5 in. long. This gives a comfortable fit.

10. Weave the main bracelet.

11. Now you will weave the body of the bracelet using cobra stitch.

It helps to secure the buckle with the free ends to your work surface with a piece of tape, so it does not move around while you're braiding.

12. Pick up the left-hand cord and thread it behind the center strands. Cross it over the top of the right-hand cord.



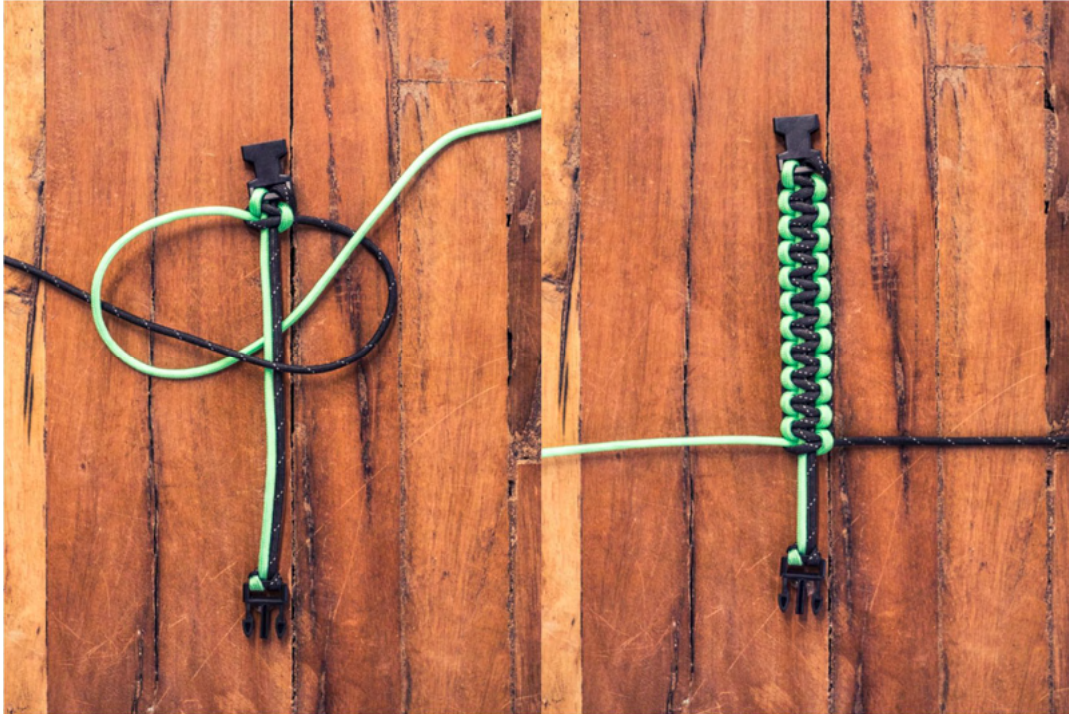
13. Pick up the right-hand cord and cross it over the center strands, then through the loop created by the left-hand cord.



14. Snug the cords tight.



15. Repeat the weave, alternating sides, until you reach the other buckle.
 - You will be able to tell if you forgot to alternate because the braid will start to rotate. Simply undo the last knot and continue.
16. Finish.



17. Once you have completed the body of the bracelet, trim the ends of the extra cord to about half an inch.
18. Burn the trimmed ends and press them to the bracelet cords to “glue” them in place. (Use the end of the lighter or pliers so you do not burn your fingers).



19. Wear your completed bracelet with pride! You will be prepared if you must secure an emergency tarp or sew a torn garment on your next adventure. Simply pull or cut the secured ends and unweave until you have the amount of cord you need.

ENGINEERING ACTIVITY: BRIDGE

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to communicate and work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

INTRODUCTION (2 MINUTES)

- Split into teams of 2-3.
- Go over the rules.
 - Make sure to identify where the bridge should be built.
 - Between two tables, the teacher can set the tables accordingly for each team.
 - Nothing should support the bridge that is from the ground. (Nothing from the floor to bridge)
 - Figure out what materials will be used.
 - Tell the participants how to earn new material, if you decide to limit the material and make teams earn more.
 - Go over how the bridge will be judged.
 - Marbles will be added to a bowl to test the weight of the bridge.

PLANNING PHASE (5 MINUTES)

- Have the teams get together to draw a plan for their bridge on paper.

BUILD PHASE (>30 MINUTES)

- The teams can use the activity balls (thumb balls), or playing cards activity, to gain more material.
 - Have the team tell you what material they want before the activity to earn more material.
 - The whole team must do whatever it says to earn all their materials.

TEST PHASE (15 MINUTES)

- Once all teams are done the test phase will begin.
- The bridge will be judged by how much weight it can hold.

INFO

Skill: Teamwork, comm.
Time: 30 Mins – 1 Hour
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Indoor

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do activity.

MATERIAL

- Bowls
- Marbles
- Tape measure
- Straws
- Wooden Craft Sticks
- Tape
- Scissors
- Activity Balls (Thumb balls)

SET UP

- Make sure all material is accessible.
- Pass out starting material, but not too much. They need to earn some more if you choose.



BREAKOUT STATIONS

OBJECTIVE

- Take some time to connect with like-minded individuals to build a sense of community.

LESSON PLAN

CARD MAKING STATION

- Make a card for your loved one, or just make some art.

SENSORY STATION

- Use sensory items for those that need to stay calm and keep their hands and minds busy.

CHILL STATION

- Need a break to yourself? Or do you just want to talk to some of the other students? This is the place.

GAME STATION

- Find someone to play a game and stretch your mind.
- This is a good time to play a game with a new friend.

NINTENDO SWITCH STATION

- Set ground rules.
- Let students take turns.

INFO

Skill: Connection
Time: 1 Hours or More
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Indoor

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do stations.

MATERIAL

- Construction Paper
- Paper
- Markers
- Crayons
- Colored Pencils
- Scissors
- Sensory blocks
- Board Games
- Card Stock- for cards
- Nintendo Switch & Accessories

SET UP

- Card Making Station
- Sensory Station
- Chill Station
 - This area should be clear of other objects.
- Game Section
- Nintendo Switch Station

YELLOW RIBBON REUNION

LIGHT AT THE END OF THE TUNNEL

REUNION TABLE OF CONTENTS

AGENDA	
MATERIAL LIST	
INTRO	
RECEPTION	
CLASSROOM CONTRACT	
ICEBREAKERS	
TEAM BUILDING	
GUTTER BALL	
ENGINEERING CHALLENGE: THE TUNNEL	
FAMILY COMPASS	
TEAM BUILDING	
BREAK OUT STATIONS	

AGENDA

DATE MONTH YEAR

OBJECTIVE

- A. Foster education, awareness, celebration, and outreach/surrounding military families.
- B. Support that promotes and sustains quality of life while building resilience and developing life skills

MATERIAL NEED

Item:
 Link:
 Price: \$
 QTY:
 Estimate: \$

TRAVEL

Origin: Name | Address, City, State, 12345
Destination(s): Name | Address, City, State, 12345
Virtual Platform: If any

AGENDA – LARGER GROUP

Day 1

8:00am	Reception	Begin to build connections.
9:00	Intro Classroom Contract Icebreakers	Develop student's connection.
9:30	Theme Activity	Gutter Ball
10:00	Break	
10:15	River Crossing	
10:45	Family Compass	(Scrabble) "Name" Family Values (according to "name")
11:30	Lunch	Work on Family Compass
12:30	Scenario	Light at the end of the Tunnel
1:45	Break	
2:00	Break Out Stations	Paracord Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch
4:00	End	

Day 2

8:30am	Reception	Continue to build connections.
9:00	Introduction	
9:30	In-Motion	Statue in the Gard, Ultimate Ninja
10:15	Break	
10:30	In-Motion	Paper, Rock, Scissors Tag, Other
11:00	Multimedia	Zootopia, Monsters U, Wreck It Ralph
11:30	Lunch	
12:30	Rope Games	Rope Handcuffs, Mine field, Blind Ropes
1:45	Break	
2:00	Break Out Stations	Paracord Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch
4:00	End	

AGENDA – SMALLER GROUP

Day 1

8:00am	Reception	Begin to build connections.
9:00	Intro Classroom Contract Icebreakers	Develop student's connection.
9:30	Theme Activity	Gutter Ball
10:00	Break	
10:15	River Crossing	
10:45	Family Compass	(Scrabble) "Name" Family Values (according to "name")
11:30	Lunch	Work on Family Compass
12:00	Multimedia	Zootopia, Monsters U, Wreck It Ralph
1:30	Scenario	Light at the end of the Tunnel
2:15	Break	
2:30	Break Out Stations	Paracord Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch
4:00	End	

Day 2

8:30am	Reception	Continue to build connections.
9:00	Introduction	
9:30	In-Motion	Statue in the Gard, Ultimate Ninja
10:15	Break	
10:30	In-Motion	Paper, Rock, Scissors Tag, Other
11:00	Multimedia	Zootopia, Monsters U, Wreck It Ralph
11:30	Lunch	
12:30	Rope Games	Rope Handcuffs, Mine field, Blind Ropes
1:45	Break	
2:00	Break Out Stations	Paracord Sensory Station Chill Station Game Station Switch
4:00	End	

TEAM BUILDING ACTIVITIES

9-SQUARE	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
BADMINTON	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
BAGS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
CAPTURE THE FLAG	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
DODGE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT CHECKERS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT CHESS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GIANT JENGA	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
GROUP GUTTER CHALLENGE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR†	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
KAN-JAM	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
LADDER GOLF	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
OMNIKIN BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
O-RING AND CHAIN	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PARACHUTE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PICKLE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
PLANK CHALLENGE BALANCE BOARDS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
ROPE GAMES BACKPACK	INDOOR†	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
SLACK LINE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
SPIDERWEB	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
SPORTS BALLS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
TARP CHALLENGE	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
WASHERS	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP†	SMALL GROUP
WHIFFLE BALL	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP
	INDOOR	OUTDOOR	LARGE GROUP	SMALL GROUP

† Notates the activity can be modified to fit the category

MATERIAL LIST

GENERAL SUPPLY

- Name Tags
- Sharpies

ELECTRONICS

- Projector
- Laptop – or a device to connect to projector
- Speaker
- Cords
- Nintendo Switch and Accessories

ART KIT

- Pencil Sharpener
- Scissors
- Glue
- Art Coloring Books
- Construction Paper
- Paper
- Markers
- Colored Pencils
- Crayons

ART ACTIVITY

- Card stock- for cards

BOARD GAMES

- Uno
- Skip-Bo
- Deck of Card
- Bananagrams
- Code Names
- One Night Werewolf

SENSORY ITEMS

- Sensory Blocks
- Legos

ACTIVITY

- Circles (poly dots)
- Ice Breaker Wheelies
- Ice Breaker Thumb Balls
- Family Compass Kit
 - Picture Frames
 - Scrabble Letters
 - Glue
 - Pencils
 - Card Stock
- Gutter Ball Kit
 - Gutters
 - Bucket or cup
 - Marbles
 - Golf Ball
 - Ping Pong Ball

ACTIVITY SHEETS

- Personal Inventory Sheet
- Card Group Challenge Sheet

ENGINEERING ACTIVITY MATERIALS

- Tape Measure
- Straws
- Tape
- Scissors
- Cups
- Paper
- Styrofoam Bowls
- Activity Balls (Thumb balls)

TEAM BUILDING EQUIPMENT- CHOOSE ACTIVITIES FROM AGENDA

Larger Group	Smaller Group
▪ 9-Square ▪ Badminton ▪ Bags ▪ Capture The Flag ▪ Dodge Ball ▪ Gutter Challenge ▪ Kan-Jam ▪ Ladder Golf ▪ Omnikin Ball ▪ Parachute ▪ Pickle Ball ▪ Plank Challenge ▪ Rope Games ▪ Slack Line ▪ Spiderweb ▪ Sports Balls ▪ Tarp Challenge ▪ Washers ▪ Whiffle Ball	▪ 9-Square ▪ Badminton ▪ Bags ▪ Dodge Ball ▪ Giant Checkers ▪ Giant Chess ▪ Giant Jenga ▪ Gutter Challenge ▪ Kan-Jam ▪ Ladder Golf ▪ O-Ring And Chain ▪ Plank Challenge ▪ Slack Line ▪ Spiderweb ▪ Sports Balls ▪ Washers

INTRODUCTION

OBJECTIVE

- Begin to build connections.

RECEPTION

- This is time for the teachers to get to know the participants. Make notes on things participants like, or do not like if you need to.

NAME TAG STATION

- First put your name on the name tag. Leave room to write something else on it later.

ART STATION

- Create art.

MIND GAMES STATION

- Play a quick game.

SCENARIO

INTRO (5 MINUTES)

- Ask the following question.
 - What brings you here today?
- Let them answer, and then go over why they are here. Respond to questions, and remember you are not a counselor but you can help them know there are others experiencing what they are going through.
- Answer:
 - Why we are here today (The teachers)?
 - Introduce the teaching team. Share a little about their experience.
 - Who is here?
 - "This is answered by our main Scenario for the day."
- Go into the Scenario.

SCENARIO (5 MINUTES)

"Your soldier has been back for a while. How have things changed? The good news is that the light is at the end of the tunnel. You are at the end of the phase and it is time to focus on skills that will help you build a better self and family unit."

(The participants will build a tunnel from point A to B that represents their journey while their soldier was deployed)

INFO

Skill:

Time: 1 Hour

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Areas for each station
- Classroom discussion area

MATERIAL

- Construction Paper
- Markers
- Colored Pencils
- Crayons
- Board Games

SET UP

- One team member will oversee registration.
- Another team member will be prepping activities.
- **Art Station-** Set up paper, markers, and items for art.
- **Name Tag Station-** Set up name tags and a marker.
- **Mind Games Station-** Set up small board games.
- **Classroom Contract-** The teacher's paper outlines the following:
 - Self
 - Group
 - Class
 - Teacher

CLASSROOM CONTRACT

CONTRACT (15-30 MINUTES)

- “We have a mission to complete, and to complete this we need to work together as a group, as a class. In order to do this let’s go over our Classroom Contract.”
- Split up into groups or stay together as a class. Ask these questions and have the students answer them out loud as a class or as a group on paper.
 - Identify Rules of Engagement
 - What do you expect from?
 - Example: Don’t talk when they are talking
 - Self-
 - Example: Be kind
 - Group- (If there are enough students)
 - Example: Be respectful to everyone
 - Class-
 - Example: To learn from them, Make class fun
 - Teachers-
 - Example: Be respectful to everyone
- If the groups answered them on paper, have them gather back at the Classroom Discussion Area. Ask each group to share what they wrote down.
 - One of the classroom leaders should be writing some of the answers that are said.
- Go over the new list and ask if everyone can agree to it.

ICEBREAKERS

OBJECTIVE

- Build connections and get to know each other.

LESSON PLAN

COMMONALITY CIRCLES (15 MINUTES)

- Have the participants place a foot on one poly dots. These poly dots should be placed in a circle.
 - There should be one poly dot for every participant, minus one.
- One participant will stand in the center.
- The person in the center will make a statement of something they have done or like.
 - I like to play or watch sports.
 - My favorite color is red.
 - I am wearing jeans.
- Once the statement is made, every participant that has that statement in common will move to a different poly dot.
 - They must move to a poly dot that is at least two away. It can't be next to them.
- One person will be left in the center. They will repeat the process.

ICEBREAKER THUMB BALL (15 MINUTES)

- Have the participants place a foot on one poly dots. These poly dots should be placed in a circle.
- Toss the ball. Once someone catches it, they will say their name then read the question where their thumb is located.
- Make sure that everyone gets a turn.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 15 – 30 Minutes

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do Icebreakers.

MATERIAL

- Circles (poly dots)
- Ice Breaker Wheelies
- Ice Breaker Thumb Ball

SET UP

- Have circle or poly dots ready for the students to grab.
- Have the thumb ball ready.

GUTTER BALL

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to communicate and work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

ACTIVITY (20 – 30 MINUTES)

- Each participant gets one gutter.
- The object is to move the marble from point A to point B without dropping the marble.
- Generally, as the facilitator you can make the pathway to point B as easy or as difficult as you like, depending how well your group works together.
- You can take them over obstacles, downstairs, around trees, etc. Get as creative as you like.

DEBRIEF (10 – 15 MINUTES)

- Go over challenges that they students face and find out how they overcome them.
 - Do they work together as a family?

INFO

Skill:

Time: 30 – 45 Minutes

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Indoor

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do the activity.

MATERIAL

- Gutter Ball Kit
 - Gutters
 - Bucket or Cup
 - Marbles
 - Golf Ball
 - Ping Pong Ball

SET UP

- Give each student a gutter.
- Go over boundaries.

ENGINEERING ACTIVITY: TUNNEL

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to communicate and work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

INTRODUCTION (2 MINUTES)

- Explain that it is now time to build the tunnel. Go over the rules.
- The goal is to create a marble tunnel using the given materials and have the marble land in an 8" square and remain there.
 - Additional points will be awarded for the distance the marbles traveled to get to the taped square.
 - The marble must not touch the floor or a team member.

PLANNING PHASE (15 MINUTES)

- Have the teams get together to draw a plan for their structure on paper.

BUILD PHASE (>45 MINUTES)

- "You may have gone through some challenges while your soldier was deployed. Think back to the beginning and then now. Remember that there is always light at the end of the tunnel."

TEST PHASE (15 MINUTES)

- Give the teams one or two test phases. This can be done at any time that they are ready.
- There will be one final test phase at the end where the teams go one after another.
- All teams must be behind a line that is identified by the teachers. This is to avoid any tunnels from taking damage.
 -

INFO

Skill: Teamwork, comm.
Time: 1 Hour
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Areas to build the tunnel from point A to point B.

MATERIAL

- Tape measure
- Straws
- Cups
- Tape
- Scissors
- Styrofoam Bowls
- Activity Balls (Thumb balls)

SET UP

- Make sure all material is accessible.
- Pass out starting material, but not too much. They need to earn some more.



FAMILY COMPASS

OBJECTIVE

- Improve communication, learn, and identify values according to the youth.

LESSON PLAN

INTRO (5 – 10 MINUTES)

- Describe an acrostic to the students and explain they will be doing a craft that involves their family values and an acrostic on a picture frame.
- Students can think about their happy place and use the 5 senses to identify things they value.
 - Have students identify times or behaviors that helped their family, made them feel good/successful/happy...
 - Have the students answer why was this time/activity/behavior so admired?
 - Identify times or seasons that hurt their family, made them feel bad/unsuccessful...why was this a problem?
 - Be honest about yourself...do you really embody this value?
- Have the students draw a picture of their happy place, or favorite place.
- Then make the acrostic by using words that describe that place.

ACTIVITY (40 – 60 MINUTES)

- Have the students right down these values that they believe are important to their family.
- Once they have some ideas, then they should grab a picture frame and letters to begin the process of building the acrostic.
- Once they have their acrostic built they should use glue to secure the letters to the frame.

DEBRIEF (# MINUTES)

- Help students create family core values unique to them. This will allow them to better understand what they stand for as a family which is the building blocks of a strong foundation especially in times of challenges.
- Help Military families create a “family compass.” This provides direction and structure which are crucial in times of stress and change.
- The families can have a better understand of what the student values in a family. This can open opportunities for the family to focus on some of those values.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 60-90 Minutes

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Indoor

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do the craft.

MATERIAL

- Picture Frame
- Card Stock
- Scrabble Letters
- Glue
- Permanent Marker
- Pencils
- Paper – to help design

SET UP

- Lay out the picture frames and scrabble letter packages.
- Lay out the picture frames and scrabble letter packages.



TEAM BUILDING

OBJECTIVE

- Learn to work together as a team.

LESSON PLAN

BULL RING (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- Have the students work together to pull all the strings out like a sunshine.
- Once the bull ring is laid out, place the ball in the center of the ring.
- Place the cup somewhere at the opposite side of the room.
- Students will work together to pick up the ball and transport it using the bull ring.
 - They must only hold the ends of the string. No creeping up.
 - If they drop the ball they must start over.
 - They are not allowed to touch the ball at any time except to place it back on the ring.

STRINGS & TUBE (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- This is like the Bull Ring. It is just using different materials.

STRINGS & HOOK (15 – 30 MINUTES)

- This is generally the most challenging one. Only do this if the students are doing the other two well. This is also like the Bull Ring, but uses a hook to pick up a hooked block.
- The final challenge is using the string and hook to pick up a mouse trap without setting it off. The students will need to figure out where to pick up the trap without triggering it.

INFO

Skill:

Time: 1 Hour

Age: ALL

Group: Any

Area: Any

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do team building.

MATERIAL

- Rope Games Backpack (Includes)
- Bull ring & Cup
- Strings & Tube set
- Strings & Hook set
- Block with hooks
- Tennis Balls
- Stand for the ball
- Various sized balls
- Mouse trap
- Ropes

SET UP

- Have an area large enough for the classroom to circle up, and move
- Lay the Bull Ring, Strings and Tube, or Strings and Hook out
- If it's the Strings and Tube set place the ball holder on the ground
- Help the students grab the ends of the strings

BREAKOUT STATIONS

OBJECTIVE

- Take some time to connect with like-minded individuals to build a sense of community.

LESSON PLAN

CARD MAKING STATION

- Make a card for your loved one, or just make some art.

SENSORY STATION

- Use sensory items for those that need to stay calm and keep their hands and minds busy.

CHILL STATION

- Need a break to yourself? Or do you just want to talk to some of the other students? This is the place.

GAME STATION

- Find someone to play a game and stretch your mind.
- This is a good time to play a game with a new friend.

NINTENDO SWITCH STATION

- Set ground rules.
- Let students take turns.

INFO

Skill: Connection
Time: 1 Hours or More
Age: ALL
Group: Any
Area: Indoor

THINGS TO IDENTIFY

- Area to do stations.

MATERIAL

- Construction Paper
- Paper
- Markers
- Crayons
- Colored Pencils
- Scissors
- Sensory blocks
- Board Games
- Card Stock- for cards
- Nintendo Switch & Accessories

SET UP

- Card Making Station
- Sensory Station
- Chill Station
 - This area should be clear of other objects.
- Game Section
- Nintendo Switch Station



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child and Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 9, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Reenlistment Resource Guide: Financial Benefits & Family Support Programs

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

... it supports the programs ability and commitment towards fostering increased soldier readiness and retention.

The artifact of the resources chart provided below delineates the resources furnished by the Child and Youth Program for Soldiers and their families, highlighting their significance in fostering readiness and retention. These top three resources, consistently available to military families and their children, are instrumental in sustaining growth in readiness and retention capacities.

Through the provision of these resources, a clear acknowledgment of their indispensability to ARNG families is demonstrated, showcasing their pivotal role in bolstering readiness and retention. These resources, namely Summer Camp, State Teen Panel, and Military Family Events, are strategically designed to cultivate resilience, hone leadership acumen, nurture relationships, and facilitate physical activities conducive to enhancing readiness and retention among military youth.

In offering these initiatives, the Child and Youth Program underscores its commitment to fortifying military families by fostering strong bonds, refining skills, and equipping them to

confront the unique challenges inherent in military life, thus fortifying readiness and retention within the community.

Reenlistment Resource Guide: Financial Benefits & Family Support Programs

Introduction

Choosing to reenlist in the Army National Guard (ARNG) goes beyond a career decision—it's a commitment to a community that actively supports you and your family in multiple dimensions: career progression, personal development, and familial well-being. This guide outlines the programs and financial advantages reinforcing why reenlistment is a beneficial choice for you and your loved ones.

Family Support Programs Overview

Our commitment is to ensure that the ARNG family has access to resources that foster resilience, development, and community. Here's how we make a difference:

1. Summer Camp for Military Kids

- **Cost:** Approximately \$600 per child annually
- **Benefits:** Cultivates resilience, prepares for military life phases, and encourages peer connections.
- **Savings:** Ensures access to enriching experiences without financial burden.

2. State Teen Panel (STP) Program

- **Cost:** Around \$1200 per child annually for retreats
- **Benefits:** Develops leadership, equips with life skills, and builds team resilience.
- **Savings:** Offers developmental opportunities at reduced or no cost.

3. Military Family Events (MFE)

- **Cost:** \$75 per child annually
 - **Benefits:** Strengthens family bonds, builds community, and promotes physical resilience.
 - **Savings:** Provides family bonding experiences with minimal financial impact.
-

Financial Benefits of Reenlistment

Reenlisting with the ARNG extends beyond securing your professional path—it envelops your family in a supportive network designed to elevate their well-being and development. The financial implications of these benefits are substantial:

Annual Cost Savings Example:

For a family with two children engaging in the above programs, the annual cost savings can sum up to over \$3750, providing significant financial relief and access to high-quality programs that nurture military children's growth and resilience.

Additional Family Support Resources

In addition to the family support programs previously outlined, military families have access to a variety of external resources aimed at enhancing their quality of life. These include memberships to Boys & Girls Clubs of America, crisis support through the Crisis Text Line, child care assistance via Child Care Aware of America, physical activity programs like HyVee Kids Fit, comprehensive services from Military OneSource, emergency communication services through The Red Cross, educational grants from Our Military Kids, USO support for troops and families, and United Through Reading's family bonding through books. These resources collectively offer comprehensive support across different aspects of military family life, from health and wellness to education and emergency assistance.

Conclusion

Reenlisting in the ARNG is a testament to your dedication to service and family. It's an opportunity to continue your professional journey while ensuring your family benefits from comprehensive support programs. These programs are not just about savings—they're about investing in your family's future, fostering environments where they can thrive alongside your career. As you contemplate your reenlistment, consider

the full spectrum of benefits available to you and your family, designed to support, develop, and enrich your collective ARNG experience.



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	MOMC Events

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE ...I am including the MOMC agendas and storyboards in my professional portfolio because they serve as concrete evidence of my ability to meet and exceed the specific performance metric of organizing two Month of the Military Child (MOMC) events annually, aligning with Competency #10: Ability to complete and submit required deliverables identified by contract and/or Government/customer. These artifacts not only showcase my commitment to fulfilling our contractual obligations but also highlight my strategic planning, resource allocation, and execution skills. By detailing the thoughtful preparation and comprehensive execution strategies for each MOMC event, the agendas and storyboards demonstrate my proficiency in managing multiple facets of event planning— from conceptualization to the creation of engaging and impactful experiences for military families. They underscore my capability to navigate the logistical and financial aspects of event management, ensuring each MOMC event not only meets but surpasses our performance metrics and expectations. Through this meticulous documentation, I illustrate my dedication to honoring and supporting military children and their families, affirming my commitment to the program's objectives and the broader mission of enhancing community support and awareness within the ARNG Community.

MOMC Agendas/Storyboards

Military Family Ball

Uniform: Class A

Civilian Attire: Formal

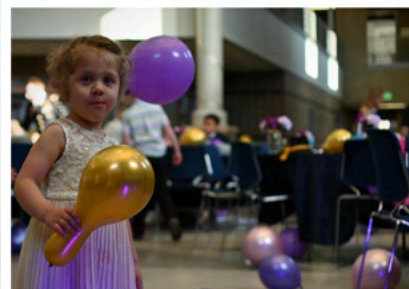
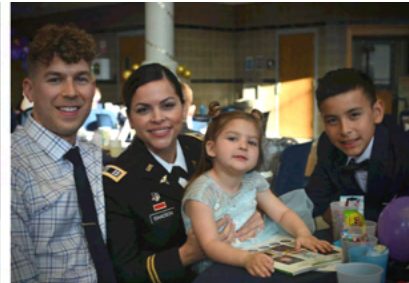
Objective:

- **A:** Create military pride (Recognition, traditions, patriotism...)
- **B:** Build opportunities for connection (Resources, peers, families, units)

- **Agenda**

- **1:00 pm - Volunteer Set Up Arrive**
- **4:45 pm - Doors Open**
- **5:00 pm - Welcome and Announcement of Schedule**
 - **Objective B:** Introduce the event's schedule while providing photo booth, activities, and crafts to immediately start building connections among attendees.
- **5:15 pm - Ceremony**
 - **Fallen Soldier Table Explained - Chaplain Lucas Murphy (3 min)**
 - **Objective A:** Honor the memory of those who have served, reinforcing military pride through recognition and traditions.
 - **Chaplain Prayer (2 min)**
 - **Objective A:** Offer a moment of reflection and unity, underpinning the event with a sense of community and shared values.
 - **National Anthem - Lori Glew (3 min)**
 - **Objective A:** Instill a sense of patriotism and collective pride through the singing of the National Anthem.
 - **Senior Leadership Comments - Leadership, Grog, Toasts (4 min)**
 - **Objective A:** Provide insights and acknowledgments from senior leadership, further embedding the significance of military traditions.
 - **CYP MOMC Message - Chris Cox (Thank You Military Youth) (4 min)**
 - **Objective B:** Specifically acknowledge and thank military youth, enhancing their sense of inclusion and recognition within the military community.

- **Dismiss by Table - Chris Cox**
 - **Objective B:** Facilitate an organized transition to dinner, encouraging continued interactions and connections.
- **5:45 pm - Dinner & Dessert**
 - **Grog Ceremony (10 to 15 Minutes)**
 - **Objective A & B:** A ceremonial activity that embodies military traditions and fosters a communal experience, encouraging conversations and shared moments among attendees.
- **6:15 pm - Dance & Activities**
 - **Objective B:** Offer a fun and engaging environment for families and individuals to connect, share experiences, and enjoy the celebration together.
- **8:00 pm - Closing Remarks - Chris Cox**
 - **Objective A & B:** Conclude the event with reflections on the evening, reinforcing the themes of military pride and the importance of community connections, while expressing gratitude for participation and unity.



Apr 29, 2023

Military Family Ball

Army National Guard youth and their families participated in an evening of celebration. These youth experienced community with one another in a memorable night filled with dancing, crafts, and delicious food.

STATS

Total Attended: 107 Family Members
Volunteers: 14
STP Representatives: 8 of 8
Net Promoter Score: 83%

OUTCOMES

"Fun for all ages. Great family atmosphere!"

"Wonderful event and greatly appreciate all the effort for our military children."

"They do such a great job making it fun for all ages!"

STP Agenda: Purple Up! Month of the Military Child

Proclamation

Date: Friday, April 7, 2023

Objective Key:

- **A:** Promote Awareness and Support for the Month of the Military Child
- **B:** Foster Civic Engagement among STP Members
- **C:** Enhance Community and Government Relations
- **D:** Educate STP Members on State Governance and History

Event Schedule

Pre-Event Preparation

- **12:45 pm: Pre-Departure Briefing at Office**
 - **Objective A & B:** Overview of the day's events, emphasizing the significance of Purple Up! and the Month of the Military Child.

Event Start

- **1:30 pm: Depart from Office**
- **2:00 pm: Arrive at Iowa State Capitol**
 - **Objective C:** Arrive and gather for a group photo outside the Capitol, showcasing unity and support for military children.

Main Activities

- **2:30 pm: Proclamation Signing with Governor**
 - **Objective A & C:** Participate in the proclamation signing ceremony, marking the official recognition of the Month of the Military Child in Iowa. STP members to wear purple to symbolize their support and solidarity.
- **3:00 pm: Capitol Tour**
 - **Objective D:** After the proclamation signing, engage in a guided tour of the Iowa State Capitol. This tour will provide STP members an educational experience on Iowa's history, state governance, and the architectural significance of the Capitol building.

- **3:30 pm: Travel to Office**

- Reflect on the day's events and discuss impressions and learned facts about state governance and the importance of recognizing military children.

Post-Event Reflection

- **4:00 pm: Debrief at Office**

- **Objective A & B:** Upon return, conduct a brief discussion on the day's experiences, focusing on the importance of civic engagement and how STP members can further contribute to raising awareness about the Month of the Military Child.



Apr 13, 2023

Proclamation Signing

An event at the Capitol, attended by Governor Kim Reynolds and 30+ family members, celebrated and honored military youth. The Governor signed a proclamation to encourage all Iowans to recognize and support military children throughout the month of April.

STATS

Total Attended: 30+ Family Members
 -18 Family members in 2022
 Volunteers: 4 STP members
 - 1 STP member in 2022

OUTCOMES

Increased awareness and support: Greater community understanding and recognition.

Increased Social Media Exposure: Greater online awareness and community support.

Increased sense of pride: Military youth feel more confident and resilient with the support of their community.



**Army National Guard
Child and Youth Services**

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	FY 24 Spend Plan

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...I am including this artifact in my professional portfolio because it serves as a tangible demonstration of my adeptness in financial management and resource allocation, specifically highlighting my commitment to executing funds in a timely and strategic manner, as delineated by monthly breakdowns. This budget sheet is a testament to my proficiency in not only adhering to but excelling within the financial management objectives set by our organization. It underscores my ability to:

Maintain Migrations out of MDEP/SAG Within Limits: By meticulously tracking expenditures and commitments month by month, I ensure that resource allocations remain within predefined limits, preventing unnecessary migrations and underscoring fiscal discipline.

Achieve a Variance of +/- 5% Between Monthly Obligations and the Validated Spend Plan: The detailed monthly breakdowns in this budget sheet have been instrumental in closely monitoring our financial activities against our validated Spend Plan. This vigilance allows for immediate adjustments, ensuring we maintain a variance within the targeted +/- 5%, thereby demonstrating my capability to manage and adjust financial plans proactively.

Conduct a Mid-Year Review to Assess Financial Health and Reallocate Resources as Necessary: This artifact illustrates the structured approach I employ in conducting thorough mid-year financial reviews. It reflects my strategic foresight in reallocating resources to address emerging needs or

Including this budget sheet in my portfolio evidenced my meticulous attention to detail, strategic planning abilities, and unwavering commitment to the financial integrity of our programs. It showcases my capacity to navigate complex financial landscapes, ensuring resources are optimized and program objectives are not just met but exceeded. Through this artifact, I aim to demonstrate my expertise in financial management and resource allocation, contributing significantly to the continued growth and success of our organization.

Execution Trend	FUNDED	UNFUNDED	MORATORIUM
FY20	\$54,000	\$79,500	\$0
FY21	\$57,500	\$67,600	\$6,300
FY22	\$69,500	\$3,300	
FY23	\$77,612		
2023 At-A-Glance Summary			
Program Overview	\$0,250		None of Spots Projected None
Government Purchased Equipment (CVPIC)	\$4,300		
Event Costs	\$65,000		
Trainable Subjects Travel	\$14,192		
Specified Volunteer Travel	\$1,000		
	Program/Event Support	\$84,000	Remaining FY23 Budget
		\$4,600	\$75,400

[illegible]



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Quarterly State Teen Panel (STP) Agendas: A Year in Review

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...I am including these Quarterly State Teen Panel (STP) Agendas in my professional portfolio because they exemplify my rigorous approach to program planning and implementation, supporting Competency #10: Ability to complete and submit required deliverables identified by contract and/or Government/customer. These agendas for events such as the Military Family Ball and STP Retreat outline a detailed execution plan that aligns with contractual objectives and showcases my ability to manage complex projects.

Through meticulous scheduling and objective alignment, such as fostering teamwork (Objective A) at the Military Family Ball and enhancing communication skills (Objective B) during STP Retreats, these documents demonstrate my strategic planning capabilities. They provide a blueprint for how each event is structured to meet specific developmental and support goals for military youth and their families, reflecting a comprehensive understanding of program needs and stakeholder expectations.

Moreover, these agendas highlight my commitment to executing funds in a timely fashion, with activities and resources allocated efficiently across months to ensure each event's success while adhering to the validated Spend Plan. By breaking down tasks and objectives by month and ensuring a +/- 5% variance between monthly obligations and the Spend Plan, I effectively manage program finances,

demonstrating fiscal responsibility and strategic resource allocation.

Incorporating feedback from previous quarters, the agendas also reflect an ongoing commitment to improvement and adaptability, showing how past insights have informed future planning. This cyclical process of planning, execution, and review underpins my ability to meet and exceed contract deliverables, ensuring the program's objectives are not just met but enhanced through thoughtful and effective program management.

Thus, these artifacts are crucial in showcasing my competencies in both program management and financial stewardship, underlining my dedication to fulfilling contractual obligations and contributing to the program's sustained success.

Quarterly State Teen Panel (STP) Agendas: A Year in Review



Apr 13, 2023

Proclamation Signing

An event at the Capitol, attended by Governor Kim Reynolds and 30+ family members, celebrated and honored military youth. The Governor signed a proclamation to encourage all Iowans to recognize and support military children throughout the month of April.

STATS

Total Attended: 30+ Family Members
-18 Family members in 2022
Volunteers: 4 STP members
- 1 STP member in 2022

OUTCOMES

Increased awareness and support: Greater community understanding and recognition.

Increased Social Media Exposure: Greater online awareness and community support.

Increased sense of pride: Military youth feel more confident and resilient with the support of their community.

Military Family Ball

For All Military Families

Date: Saturday, April 27, 2024

Time: Starting at 5:00 PM CDT

Location: JFHQ, 6100 NW 78th Ave, Johnston, IA 50131

Objective Key:

- **A: Foster Teamwork and Collaboration among STP Members and Volunteers**
- **B: Enhance Communication Skills through Event Coordination and Guest Interaction**
- **C: Promote Awareness of Military Family Support Services**
- **D: Create an Elegant and Memorable Experience for Military Families**

Event Schedule

Pre-Event Setup

- **2:00 PM: STP Members and Volunteers Arrive**
 - **Objective A: Coordination meeting to assign roles and discuss the evening's flow, ensuring a shared understanding of tasks.**
- **2:30 PM: Venue Preparation**
 - **Objective D: Decorate the venue, set up signage, and prepare the registration area, focusing on creating a welcoming and elegant atmosphere.**

Event Commencement

- **5:00 PM: Guest Arrival and Registration**

- **Objective B & C: Greet guests warmly, assist with coat check, and guide them to the reception area, providing information on available support services discreetly.**
- **5:30 PM: Opening Remarks**
 - **Welcoming speech by a senior military official and STP representative, acknowledging the contributions and sacrifices of military families.**

Main Event

- **6:00 PM: Dinner Service Begins**
 - **Objective D: Ensure a seamless dining experience with STP members assisting as needed, allowing families to enjoy the meal without interruptions.**
- **7:00 PM: Keynote Speaker**
 - **A notable figure within the military community shares insights and stories, reinforcing the evening's themes of honor, resilience, and unity.**
- **7:30 PM: Entertainment and Dancing**
 - **Objective D: A mix of live music and DJ sets cater to all ages, with STP members facilitating dance contests and engaging guests to participate.**

Special Activities

- **Throughout the Evening: Photo Booth and Memory Lane**
 - **Objective B & C: Invite guests to capture moments at the photo booth and share stories at the Memory Lane display, manned by STP members who can engage in meaningful conversations.**

Closing Ceremony

- **9:30 PM: Closing Remarks**

- **Objective A: Brief thank-you speech, recognizing the efforts of the STP members, volunteers, and acknowledging the guests for their participation.**
- **9:45 PM: Final Dance**
 - **A special last dance, inviting all guests to the floor, symbolizing unity and shared experiences.**
- **10:00 PM: Event Conclusion**
 - **Guests begin to depart, with STP members and volunteers assisting as necessary and ensuring everyone leaves with positive memories.**

Post-Event

- **10:30 PM: Clean-Up and Debrief**
 - **Objective A & D: STP members and volunteers collaborate on post-event clean-up, followed by a quick debrief to discuss the event's success and areas for improvement.**



Mar 10-12, 2023

State Teen Panel

Army National Guard holds quarterly meetings with an elect group of teens to challenge, grow, and develop our next generation leaders. State Teen Panel members are expected to give back to their community and support local events in their area.

STATS

Total Attended: 6/8
Volunteers: 3
Hours of Training: 22
NPS Score - n/a

OUTCOMES

Established best practices for promoting MOMC in their areas.

Celebrated Madison Price's last event with the program. Madison served 4 years on the panel and attended many events over the past decade.

The group bagged 3000 lbs. of rice for people in need!

STP Retreat Agenda

Objective Key:

- **A:** Enhance Communication Skills
- **B:** Promote Physical Fitness and Well-being
- **C:** Foster Teamwork and Collaboration
- **D:** Encourage Community Engagement and Service
- **E:** Develop Technical or Artistic Skills
- **F:** Encourage Personal Growth and Resilience
- **G:** Planning and Organizational Skills
- **H:** Cultivate Creativity and Innovation

STP Retreat Agenda Objectives

Friday

PM

- **12:30** - Pick up rental vehicle

- **3:00** - Arrive at hotel and prepare conference room for STP
- **Objective G:** Set up a conducive environment for learning and interaction.
 - **5:00** - STP Arrive at Hotel and Unpack
 - **5:30** - Dinner (Conversation about MOMC)
- **Objective A & C:** Discuss and exchange ideas on Month of the Military Child involvement and encouragement strategies while collaborating ideas.
- **6:30** - Team Building (Ice breakers, Rope Exercises, Games, etc.)
- **Objective C & H:** Engage in activities that promote unity and creativity among participants. ● **9:00** - Lights out

Saturday AM

- **8:00** - Breakfast (Talk about book *Do Hard Things*)
- **Objective F:** Motivate STP to undertake personal challenges and encourage STP members to read and reflect through the book. ● **9:00** - Educational/Skill Lesson (Photography)
- **Objective E & H:** Learn a new artistic skill, fostering creativity and stepping out of comfort zones.
- **11:30** - Lunch (Subway)

Saturday PM

- **1:00** - Community Service Opportunity (Northeast Iowa Food Bank)
- **Objective D:** Provide service to the local community, reinforcing the importance of civic engagement.
- **3:00** - Resilience Building & Training w/ Exercise (Ninja U)
- **Objective B & F:** Develop physical fitness while encouraging resilience through challenging activities.
 - **5:30** - Dinner (Pizza Ranch)
 - **6:30** - Return to hotel
 - **7:00** - Team Building (teamwork games)

- **Objective C:** Strengthen team dynamics through engaging and cooperative games.

Sunday AM

- **8:00** - Breakfast (at hotel)
- **8:30** - Summer Schedule and Plan

- **Objective G:** Collaboratively create a summer schedule that facilitates growth and involvement.

- **9:00** - STP Support/Team Building/Encouragement

- **Objective A & F:** Write notes of encouragement to reinforce the community bond and

acknowledge individual efforts. ● **9:45** - After Action Review (AAR)

- **Objective G:** Reflect on the retreat's events, discuss what went well, and identify areas for improvement.

- **10:00** - Clean Up and STP Travel

- **Objective G:** Demonstrate responsibility and care for the environment by leaving it in good condition.

- **10:30** - Travel back to Des Moines
- **1:00** - Return Rental at Enterprise in Johnston



Dec 9th, 2023

Cookies w/ Santa

Army National Guard youth and their families were able to celebrate the holidays by taking a photo with Santa (made into an ornament). In conjunction with this event we held an overnight State Teen Panel where the teens were challenged to be leaders, mentors to their peers, and provide event support.

STATS

Total Registered/Attended: 215/155

Total Volunteers: 18

Net Promoter Score: 100%

All customers are promoters. Indicates outstanding customer satisfaction and brand loyalty.

SURVEY RESPONSES

"We loved santa! The table crafts were easy and fun for all ages."

"These are important events to help our families meet and connect to show support for one another and build relationships"

"Our kiddos had a blast, and we always have a fun time attending!"

STP Summit Agenda

December 9-10, 2023 - Des Moines, IA

Objective Key:

- **A:** Foster Teamwork and Collaboration
- **B:** Enhance Communication Skills
- **C:** Engage with Military Culture and Resources
- **D:** Promote Community and Family Engagement

Saturday, December 9

- **9:30 am: Arrive**
 - Travel to Des Moines, IA.
- **10:00 am: STP Members Arrive!**

- **Objective C:** Setup - Arrange marketing materials, cookies, crafts, lighting, and camera to welcome STP members and families, showcasing Child & Youth Program (CYP) resources.
- **12:00 pm: Reception - Begin to Build Connections**
 - **Objective D:** Warmly welcome military youth and families, fostering an environment conducive to open communication and connection.
- **12:30 pm: Santa Arrives!**
 - **Objective D:** Introduce a festive element to the event, providing an engaging experience for families and highlighting community support.
- **1:45 pm: Tear Down (conference room)**
- **2:00 pm: Pack up and Finish After Action Review (AAR)**
 - **Objective A:** Reflect on the event's success and areas for improvement, emphasizing teamwork and collaborative evaluation.
- **3:00 pm: Escape Room/Team Building for STP Members**
 - **Objective A:** Engage members in a team-building exercise designed to enhance problem-solving skills, cooperation, and group cohesion.
- **5:30 pm: Dinner with STP Members (Pizza Ranch)**
 - **Objective B & D:** Provide a casual setting for members to discuss the day's events, share experiences, and strengthen community ties.
- **7:00 pm: Team Building Activities with STP Members**
 - **Objective A:** Continue to build upon teamwork and collaboration through interactive and fun activities, further solidifying group dynamics.

Sunday, December 10

- **8:00 am: Breakfast**
 - Begin the day with a communal meal, offering an opportunity for informal discussions and planning for the day ahead.
- **9:00 am: Schedule and Plan for STP Retreat**
 - **Objective B & C:** Discuss the upcoming STP Retreat, outlining objectives, activities, and how these align with the broader goals of supporting military youth and families.
- **11:00 am: Clean Up and STP Travel**
 - Conclude the summit with a collaborative clean-up effort, emphasizing the importance of responsibility and teamwork within the community.

Region 7 Symposium Agenda: Behind The Scenes

Dates: July 17th - July 21, 2023

Location: Hilton Branson Convention Center Hotel, Branson, MO

Objective Key:

- **A:** Foster Self-awareness and Leadership Skills
- **B:** Enhance Teamwork through Creative and Recreational Activities
- **C:** Encourage Community Service and Social Responsibility
- **D:** Promote Reflective Learning and Personal Growth

Monday, July 17th

- **1:00pm - 3:00pm:** States Arrive, Check In, and Announcements.
Personal Time for Unpacking and Relaxation.
- **3:00pm - 4:30pm:** Welcome and Symposium Overview.
Objective A & D: Set expectations, introduce themes, and kick off reflective journaling.
- **4:30pm - 5:00pm:** Break/Prep for Dinner.
- **5:15pm - 6:15pm:** Dinner - **All Participants.**
- **6:30pm - 6:45pm:** Energizer Activity.
Objective B: Engage in a quick, energizing activity to foster camaraderie among participants.
- **6:45pm - 8:45pm:** AFAP Session - Identify and Prioritize Youth Issues.
Objective D: Dive deep into issues affecting the youth, promoting a culture of open dialogue and reflection.
- **9:00pm - 10:00pm:** Transition to Hotel Rooms. Reflection Journal Entry.
Objective D: Encourage personal reflection on the day's discussions and activities.
- **10:00pm:** Lights Out.

Tuesday, July 18th

- **8:00am - 8:45am:** Breakfast and Share Reflection Journal Insights.
Objective D: Share reflections from the previous day, fostering a community of shared learning.
- **8:45am - 9:00am:** Travel to Fritz Adventure.
- **9:00am - 11:25am:** Team Building Course on Ropes at Fritz Adventure.
Objective B: Strengthen teamwork and collaboration skills in a challenging and fun environment.
- **11:25am - 12:25pm:** Lunch Break.
- **12:25pm - 3:00pm:** STEAM Workshop - Paint with a Twist.
Objective A & B: Explore self-awareness and adaptability through collaborative painting, pushing comfort zones.

- **3:15pm - 4:15pm:** Leadership Workshop.
Objective A: Focus on leadership styles and personal development.
- **5:45pm - 6:00pm:** Dinner and Evening Activities.
Objective B: Enjoy a meal together, followed by chosen recreational activities.
- **10:00pm:** Lights Out.

Wednesday, July 19th - Friday, July 21st

Consistent Morning Routine:

- Breakfast and reflective journaling, focusing on personal growth and experiences shared.

Key Activities Include:

- **Say It With Music Workshop:** Collaborative songwriting/recording, emphasizing emotional expression and group dynamics.
- **Community Service Project:** Engaging in a service activity to contribute positively to the local community.
- **Group Selected Activity:** Participating in a recreational activity chosen by the teens, highlighting the importance of leisure and fun in personal development.

Evening Routine:

- Dinners followed by personal time and preparation for the next day.
- Nightly reflection journal entry and lights out to ensure rest and personal reflection.

Closing Day, Friday, July 21st

- **8:00am - 9:30am:** Final Breakfast and Share Reflection Journal Entry; Check Out.
Objective D: Wrap up the symposium with shared experiences, lessons learned, and farewell reflections.
- **10:00am - 11:00am:** Closing Recognition and Youth Farewells.
Objective D: Acknowledge the achievements and growth of participants, closing the symposium on a high note.
- **11:00am:** States Depart/Symposium Conclusion.

This detailed agenda for the Region 7 Symposium is structured around key objectives designed to enhance leadership, teamwork, community service, and personal reflection, ensuring a comprehensive and enriching experience for all participants.



Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 3, 4, 7, 8, 11
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	MOMC Events

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE

...it illustrates my commitment to continuous professional growth and development, particularly in enhancing my understanding and skills to better support military-connected students and their families. This module is a part of a comprehensive training that totals six hours across five modules, aimed at deepening educators' awareness of the unique challenges faced by military families and providing effective strategies for their support.

The first module, "Understanding the Need," not only broadened my knowledge of the distinctive needs of military-connected students but also equipped me with the tools to advocate for these students more effectively within the educational system. By learning about the Military Interstate Children's Compact Commission (MIC3) and the role of the military liaison, I have applied this new understanding to improve practice within my school, ensuring a supportive environment for military families.

Additionally, this training has enabled me to work collaboratively with colleagues to enhance our professional practices in supporting youth learning, directly addressing Competency 11's emphasis on collaborative improvement. The module's focus on devising a plan for a committee for military-connected students at schools has fostered teamwork and shared commitment among staff to meet the needs of our military families.

Moreover, this handbook represents my application of research and knowledge from

professional development opportunities to improve practice. It signifies a tangible step in establishing and implementing a professional development plan based on the needs of our military-connected students, aligning with Competency 11's requirements.

In conclusion, this artifact showcases my proactive approach to professional learning, especially in areas critical to the welfare of military families. It reflects my dedication to applying comprehensive research and insights to enhance educational practices, contributing to the overall goal of fostering a supportive and understanding school community for military-connected students.

CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION

THIS HEREBY CERTIFIES THAT

has completed the course

Rebecca I. Porter

REBECCA I. PORTER, PHD

*President and CEO,
Military Child Education Coalition*

Date of Event

Clock Hours



MCEC[®]

909 Mountain Lion Circle | Harker Heights, TX 76548 | 254.953.1923 | MilitaryChild.org | CFC #10261

Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	2025 Annual Report — Selected Program Results

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

The annual report gives me a concise way to look back at what our Iowa team delivered during 2025. It connects program activity with participation, volunteer support, regional outreach, partnerships, resilience training, and State Teen Panel work. Erin and I work on these projects together, so I am including the results as team evidence rather than claiming the report as an individual product.

2025 Annual Report — Program Results

Source: 2025_Annual_Report.pdf

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Selected figures are transcribed from the program's annual report. The source report identifies Chris Cox and Erin Coogler as the Iowa CYP team.

Measure	Reported result
ARNG youth reached	1,121
ARNG adults reached	2,339
ANG youth reached	116
ANG adults reached	159
Program hours	289.75
New Facebook followers	111
Volunteers trained	153
Volunteer hours	549
State Teen Panel meetings	4
Events supported by STP	16
STP hours	133.5
Youth trained in MRT	9

Program purpose reported: advocate for and support military youth throughout Iowa through program events, life-skills instruction, and access to resources.

2025 Annual Report — Reach, Partnerships, and Practices

Source: 2025_Annual_Report.pdf

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Regional outreach

The report shows participation beyond Des Moines, including Waterloo, Sioux City, Cedar Rapids, Davenport, and Council Bluffs. This supports the statewide and geographically dispersed nature of the program.

Partnerships documented

EveryStep, Iowa Select Farms, Capitol City Church, USO, Pay It Forward Always, Jester Park Equestrian Center, and Heroes Helping Heroes are identified as program partners.

Practices worth sharing

The report highlights the Iowa team's Lemons Inc. workbook and companion app, along with a no-cost, multi-day horse camp that served 51 military-connected youth ages 9–17.

Youth leadership and resilience

The State Teen Panel supported events, service projects, mentoring, and the Region 7 Teen Symposium. The report also documents adaptation of Master Resilience Training content for teens.

Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 4, 5, 6, 7, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Master Event Tasklist — Responsibility Excerpts

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

This shared task list documents the responsibilities I handle and the work Erin and I coordinate together. It shows how an event moves from an initial record and budget estimate through venue, registration, promotion, final preparation, attendance, and lessons learned. The ownership column is useful evidence because it separates my tasks, Erin's tasks, and the items assigned to both of us.

Master Event Tasklist — Military Family Events

Source: Master Event Tasklist

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Representative rows selected to show ownership and the full event cycle. No family or participant information is included.

Event / Phase	Task	Owner	Timing
Military Family Event / Foundation	Create event record	Chris	90 days before
Military Family Event / Foundation	Set initial capacity	Chris	85 days before
Military Family Event / Event Details	Confirm venue and document logistics	Both	70 days before
Military Family Event / Event Details	Request vendor documentation	Chris	60 days before
Military Family Event / Event Details	Send purchase request with required documents and estimate	Chris	60 days before
Military Family Event / Event Details	Build budget estimate	Chris	60 days before
Military Family Event / Registration	Create registration form	Erin	45 days before
Military Family Event / Registration	Publish registration link	Chris	40 days before
Military Family Event / Promotion	Create flyer copy	Chris	35 days before
Military Family Event / Promotion	Create marketing graphics	Erin	35 days before
Military Family Event / Promotion	Launch website, email, and social promotion	Both	30 days before
Military Family Event / Final Prep	Send final team brief	Chris	1 day before
Military Family Event / Closeout	Complete event notes and lessons learned	Both	7 days after

Master Event Tasklist — Proclamation Ceremony

Source: Master Event Tasklist

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Event / Phase	Task	Owner	Timing
Proclamation / Foundation	Create event record	Chris	90 days before
Proclamation / Event Details	Confirm date and time	Chris	75 days before
Proclamation / Event Details	Confirm venue logistics	Both	70 days before
Proclamation / Event Details	Coordinate leadership participation	Chris	90 days before
Proclamation / Event Details	Draft ceremony agenda and speaking flow	Chris	90 days before
Proclamation / Promotion	Create invitation copy	Chris	25 days before
Proclamation / Promotion	Coordinate public affairs	Both	14 days before
Proclamation / Final Prep	Confirm speakers	Chris	5 days before
Proclamation / Final Prep	Send final logistics	Chris	2 days before
Proclamation / Closeout	Share photos and recap	Chris	2 days after
Proclamation / Closeout	Complete event notes	Both	5 days after

Master Event Tasklist — Purple Up! Day

Source: Master Event Tasklist

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Event / Phase	Task	Owner	Timing
Purple Up! / Foundation	Create event record	Chris	120 days before
Purple Up! / Foundation	Set campaign scope, schools, partners, and statewide goals	Both	110 days before
Purple Up! / Event Details	Coordinate school outreach	Erin	90 days before
Purple Up! / Event Details	Build classroom-kit and distribution plan	Chris	75 days before
Purple Up! / Event Details	Plan or purchase shirts, kits, and promotional items	Chris	As scheduled

What the excerpts document

The task list shows lead time, priority, required status, task ownership, purchasing documentation, budget estimating, registration, communications, leadership coordination, staff briefing, attendance, and after-action notes. It also shows where work is shared with Erin rather than assigned to one person.

Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	2026 Military Family Ball — Planning Excerpts

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

The Military Family Ball plan shows the amount of coordination behind one statewide family event. My assigned parts included the welcome, leadership introduction, prayer, dinner dismissal, and closing remarks. The larger plan also records the work shared across the CYP team, State Teen Panel, partners, volunteers, vendors, and senior leaders.

2026 Military Family Ball — Event Framework

Source: Military Family Ball

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Saturday, April 25, 2026 | Camp Dodge, Pool Pavilion

Event objectives

Create military pride through recognition, traditions, and patriotism; and build opportunities for connection among resources, peers, families, and units.

Program flow

Guest arrival and State Teen Panel hospitality; opening program; National Anthem; Fallen Soldier Table tribute; senior-leader remarks and volunteer recognition; dinner; youth-led grog ceremony; dancing and activities; closing remarks.

Assigned to Chris

Welcome and announcements; senior-leader introduction; prayer; organized dinner dismissal; and closing remarks.

Assigned to Erin and senior STP members

Grog ceremony.

2026 Military Family Ball — Coordination Evidence

Source: Military Family Ball

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Work area	Evidence in the plan
Youth leadership	STP members greet guests, provide hospitality, support activities, and help lead the grog ceremony.
Partnerships	The plan names Iowa Select Farms, INGOAUX, Capitol City Church, and other contributors.
Volunteer coordination	Volunteer and partner recognition, station assignments, setup roles, and event support are built into the plan.
Communications	The document includes MC transitions, speaker introductions, printed agendas, invitations, and public-facing event details.
Risk and readiness	First-aid supplies, check-in procedures, final logistics, equipment status, and assigned setup/tear-down work are included.
Closeout	The tear-down list covers packing, inventory return, table and chair storage, waste removal, cleaning, and final walkthrough.

Selected planning details

The working plan includes a photographer checklist, setup and tear-down assignments, packing status, print quantities, check-in materials, activity supplies, sponsor recognition, the Fallen Soldier Table script, and a complete MC script.

2026 Military Family Ball — Chris's Program Responsibilities

Source: Military Family Ball

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

5:05 PM — Welcome and announcements

Open the event, welcome families, state the purpose of the gathering, recognize the service and sacrifice of military families, and provide event logistics.

5:22 PM — Senior-leader introduction

Introduce the senior leader and connect the leader's role to support for military families.

5:45 PM — Prayer and 5:50 PM — dinner dismissal

Move the program from formal remarks into dinner while keeping the schedule and guest flow organized.

8:00 PM — Closing remarks

Thank attendees and recognize the families, volunteers, partners, and program community that made the event possible.

Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	2026 State Teen Panel Retreat — Agenda Excerpts

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

This agenda shows how we used the retreat for leadership development, team building, service, program planning, and reflection. I led the camp tour, rules and expectations, and the first team-building session. Erin led a later CYP team-building block, and the rest of the weekend reflects the work we planned and carried out together.

2026 State Teen Panel Retreat — Agenda

Source: STP Retreat Agenda 2026

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

March 6–8, 2026 | Des Moines YMCA Camp

Time	Agenda item / ownership
Friday 2:00–5:30 PM	Load supplies, travel, set up, welcome members, complete required paperwork, and dinner.
Friday 6:15 PM	Camp tour, rules, and expectations — led by Chris.
Friday 6:30 PM	Team-building activities — hosted by CYP/Chris; includes Hunt the Good Stuff journals and veteran service-project work.
Saturday 9:00 AM	Leadership training hosted by Y Camp.
Saturday 1:00–3:00 PM	Service project.
Saturday 3:00 PM	STP updates and planning for MOMC, Purple Up school participation, proclamation signing, Military Family Ball, regional symposium, elevator speech, and teen-panel leadership brief.
Saturday 6:45 PM	Team-building and Military Family Ball brainstorming — hosted by CYP team/Erin.
Sunday 9:00 AM	Encouragement notes and after-action review, including teen reflections and selected quotes for reports and outreach.

2026 State Teen Panel Retreat — Program Elements

Source: STP Retreat Agenda 2026

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Leadership and belonging

The retreat combines structured leadership instruction with small-group activities that help teens learn about one another, identify common ground, and practice communication.

Service and military-family connection

The weekend includes a service project, Hunt the Good Stuff journals, and planning tied to Month of the Military Child, Purple Up, the proclamation ceremony, and the Military Family Ball.

Youth voice

STP members brainstorm regional-symposium content, prepare an elevator speech, contribute to a leadership brief, and complete written reflections after the event.

Evaluation and follow-through

The Sunday after-action review captures teen feedback and notes that can be used in reports, outreach, and future planning.

Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	1, 2, 3, 4, 8, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	2026 Military Youth Summer Camp — Program Plan Excerpts

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

The summer-camp plan connects each part of the week to two program objectives: strengthening awareness and connection among military families, and supporting quality of life through resilience and life-skills development. This is shared CYP work. I am including it because it shows how the team translates broad goals into a daily schedule, partner activities, reflection, recognition, and family check-out.

2026 Military Youth Summer Camp — Daily Framework

Source: Military Youth Summer Camp 2026

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

July 19–25, 2026 | Des Moines YMCA Camp

Objective A: Foster education, awareness, celebration, and outreach surrounding military families.

Objective B: Support quality of life while building resilience and developing life skills.

Schedule block	Purpose documented in the plan
Breakfast, lunch, and dinner / cabin community	Friendship, peer connection, informal discussion, and belonging among military-connected youth.
C.L.A.S. sessions	Hands-on instruction, skill development, confidence, and appropriate challenge.
Open afternoon activities	Choice, independence, decision-making, social engagement, perseverance, problem-solving, confidence, and resilience.
Creative arts	Self-expression, teamwork, positive social interaction, and new skills.
Evening programs and camp traditions	Community, recognition, belonging, and reflection on personal growth.
Evening reflection	Self-awareness, character development, gratitude, and personal growth.

2026 Military Youth Summer Camp — Featured Programming

Source: Military Youth Summer Camp 2026

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Date / activity	Objective connection
July 19 — arrival, check-in, and orientation	Registration, peer connection, and entry into the military-youth camp community.
July 21 — trucker-hat workshop with Pay It Forward	Creativity, confidence, and hands-on learning.
July 22 — Chaplain Murphy	Leadership, resilience, military life, character, discussion, and reflection.
July 23 — paint-by-number workshop with Pay It Forward	Mindfulness, patience, creativity, and stress management.
July 24 — military-appreciation cards	Gratitude, empathy, and recognition of service.
July 24 — closing recognition	Accomplishments, friendships, leadership, and growth.
July 25 — parent program and check-out	Family sharing, strengthened relationships, confidence, and connection to the military community.

Examples of planned activities: archery, swimming, horseback riding, climbing, outdoor education, team-building challenges, sports, arts and crafts, camp projects, campfires, recognition ceremonies, chapel, and reflection experiences.

Army National Guard Child and Youth Services

LCYPC and CYPC Professional Competency Areas

NAME	Chris Cox
TITLE	Child & Youth Program Coordinator
STATE/TERRITORY	Iowa

IDENTIFIED COMPETENCY(IES)	3, 6, 7, 10
ARTIFACT TITLE OR DESCRIPTION	Social Media Tracker — Representative Outreach Excerpts

I AM INCLUDING THIS ARTIFACT IN MY PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO BECAUSE...

The social-media tracker is a shared working record for outreach. It helps the team plan dates, identify the purpose of each post, keep source materials together, and confirm what was scheduled or published. I am including a limited excerpt because the full sheet is lengthy and contains operational links and contact details that do not belong in a public-facing portfolio.

Social Media Tracker — Representative Entries

Source: Social Media Tracker

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

The excerpt omits personal contact information and limits long post copy to a topic summary.

Date	Type	Topic	Status / evidence
Oct. 1, 2024	Resource	Weekend drill childcare / Upwards	Posted; supporting flyer tracked
Oct. 8, 2024	Resource	Scholarship and grant database	Posted; website resource link tracked
Oct. 10, 2024	Event RSVP	Fall Family Festival reminder	Posted; registration link and flyer tracked
Oct. 14, 2024	Event recap	Fall Family Festival thank-you	Posted; post text retained
Oct. 15, 2024	Education resource	Military Child Education Coalition	Posted; educator training and resource link tracked
Oct. 17, 2024	Family resource	Family Dinner Project	Posted; family connection resource tracked
Oct. 22, 2024	Program story	Appreciation for military youth	Posted; message retained
Oct. 29, 2024	Community resource	American Legion	Posted; partner/resource link tracked

Social Media Tracker — What the Tool Documents

Source: Social Media Tracker

[Open the source file in Google Drive](#)

Planning

Each row connects a planned date with a content type, topic, supporting file or link, publishing status, and post copy.

Program access

Tracked posts direct families to registration, childcare, scholarships, education resources, community organizations, and family-support tools.

Event communication

The tracker includes registration reminders, event materials, recaps, and thank-you messages so communication continues before and after an event.

Documentation

Published status and retained copy make it possible to review what was shared, reuse accurate information, and identify gaps in future outreach.

Team attribution

This is presented as a shared Iowa CYP working tool. The portfolio does not claim that Chris individually wrote or posted every entry.